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Micah - Introduction

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Part 1: General Introduction

Outline of Micah

1. Yahweh announces judgment on his people and their leaders (1–3)
2. Yahweh promises future restoration and righteous rule (4–5)
3. Yahweh calls his people to repentance and offers hope (6–7)

What is the Book of Micah about?
This book contains many of Micah's prophecies. Micah repeated many similar prophecies as found in Isaiah. Micah warned the kingdoms of Israel and Judah that the Assyrians would soon attack them. Micah condemned those who acted unjustly and immorally. He spoke against those who did not work for a living. He also spoke against the false prophets in Israel and Judah. These false prophets were telling the people that Yahweh would never let a foreign kingdom harm or conquer them.

Micah called the people to please Yahweh by living righteous and holy lives. However, the sinful way they lived and the unjust way they treated their fellow countrymen proved that they no longer wanted to obey and honor Yahweh.

How should the title of this book be translated?
Translators may decide to translate the traditional title "The Book of Micah" or just "Micah" in a way that is clearer to the readers. They may decide to call it "The Sayings of Micah."

Who wrote Micah?
The prophet Micah wrote this book. Micah lived at the same time as Isaiah and Hosea. This was sometime between 750 and 700 B.C., during the reigns of Jotham, Ahaz, and Hezekiah, kings of Judah. He began prophesying when he lived in the northern kingdom of Israel. Then he moved to the kingdom of Judah.

Part 2: Important Religious and Cultural Concepts

Who is the deliverer Micah mentions?
Micah frequently mentioned a king who would deliver the people. It is clear that Micah meant the Messiah, the descendant of David who would rule forever, though he never referred to him as the Messiah.

Were the Israelites required to offer sacrifices or live holy lives to please Yahweh?
Many of the Old Testament writers were concerned with offering sacrifices according to the law of Moses. However, Micah explained to the people that Yahweh was pleased only when they offered these sacrifices in faith. Without faith, the sacrifices had no meaning.

Part 3: Important Translation Issues

What does a translator need to know before translating Micah?
Micah did not often explain how his prophecies were historically situated. This may result in the translator failing to understand implicit information unless they understand Micah's time. It is therefore suggested that translators understand well the history of the kingdoms of Israel and Judah.

How do I translate passages where the speaker or addressee is not mentioned explicitly?
Micah did not usually say who was speaking or who was being addressed. Reading the verses before and after the quote will often help the reader to understand who is speaking or being addressed. It is acceptable to make this information explicit so the reader can more easily understand it.

"let" and "may"
The ULT uses the English helping verbs "let" and "may" to show that a speaker is expressing a desire that something happen or that someone do something. It uses the verb "let" for more assertive expressions, and it uses the verb "may" for more deferential expressions. For example, when David says in Psalms 69:34 "Let the heavens and the earth praise him," he means "I want the heavens and the earth to praise him." Languages that do not have a volitional form might say "The heavens and earth ought to praise him," or they might use an imperative, "Praise him, heavens and earth!" When Micah says in 5:9 "May your hand rise over your adversaries," he is being more deferential, even though his wish is urgent, because he is addressing Yahweh, a superior. Languages that do not have a volitional form might say "Yahweh, I desire that your hand rise over your adversaries," or they might use an imperative with an indication that it is a polite request, "Yahweh, please defeat your adversaries." Translate this volitional form in the most natural way in your language to indicate that the speaker is expressing what he wants someone to do or what he wishes someone would do.

How should the text of Micah be formatted?
The ULT uses a poetic language style like the Hebrew text. Many languages can do this but some languages

will not be able to do this. The ULT also sets apart the poetic portions of the text by setting the poetic lines farther to the right on the page than the rest of the text. With the exception of the first verse, the entire book is indented because the prophecies were written as a series of poems.

Micah - Chapter 1 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Micah is written mainly in a poetic form. Most of the prophets wrote to either the Northern Kingdom or the Southern Kingdom. Micah wrote to both of them at times without clear distinction, as he did in this chapter.

1. Yahweh comes to judge the nations (1–5)
2. Samaria is destroyed because of its sin (6–7)
3. Micah mourns the coming judgment on Judah (8–16)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Idolatry as prostitution

Samaria's idols are called a prostitute's wages, portraying idolatry as unfaithfulness to Yahweh.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

City names

Several times in this chapter, the names of the cities are used to describe their destruction. This sounds unusual in English because of its construction in Hebrew. It contains several "plays on words." "Lachish will be lashed" is an example of this type of construction. This kind of poetic element rarely carries into other languages but including the information in a footnote may be helpful.

Micah 1:1 (#1)

דְּבַר־יְהוָה ׀ אֲשֶׁר הָיָה אֶל־מִיכָהּ הַמּֽוֹרַשְׁתִּי בִּימֵי יוֹתָם אָחָז יְחִזְקִיָּה מַלְכֵי יְהוּדָה אֲשֶׁר־חָזָה עַל־שֹׁמְרוֹן וִירוּשָׁלָֽם

"The word of Yahweh that was to Micah the Morashtite in the days of Jotham, Ahaz, {and} Hezekiah, kings of Judah, which he saw concerning Samaria and Jerusalem"

Micah is speaking of himself in the third person as **Micah** and **he** to introduce this book.

See: First, Second or Third Person

Micah 1:1 (#2)

אֲשֶׁר־חָזָה

"which he saw"

The pronoun **he** refers to Micah. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [which Micah saw]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 1:1 (#3)

דְּבַר־יְהוָה

"The word of Yahweh"

Micah is using the possessive form to describe a **word** that comes from **Yahweh**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [The word from Yahweh]

See: Possession

Micah 1:2 (#1)

הַקְשִׁיבִי אֶֽרֶץ

"pay attention, earth"

Micah is speaking to the **earth**, which he knows cannot hear him. He is doing this to communicate to the people listening to him that he feels very strongly about the judgment that Yahweh is about to bring. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate these words as if he were speaking directly to the people about the earth. Alternate translation: [everyone on earth should pay attention]

See: Apostrophe

Micah 1:2 (#2)

אֶֽרֶץ וּמְלֹאָהּ

"earth, and its fullness"

Here, **its fullness** represents everything and everyone that fills the earth. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [earth, and everything and everyone in it]

See: Metonymy

Micah 1:2 (#3)

מֵהֵיכַל קָדְשׁוֹ

"from the palace of his holiness"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **holiness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [from his holy palace]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 1:3 (#1)

כִּי־הִנֵּה

“For behold”

Micah is using the term **behold** to focus his listeners’ attention on what he is about to say. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation. Alternate translation: [Pay attention for]

See: Foreground Information

Micah 1:3 (#2)

וְדָרַךְ עַל־בָּמוֹתֵי אָרֶץ

“and tread on the high places of the earth”

Micah is speaking of Yahweh acting with power over the earth as if he would **tread on the high places of the earth**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [act with power over even the highest places of the earth]

See: Metaphor

Micah 1:4 (#1)

וְנָמַסּוּ הֶהָרִיםתַּחְתָּיו

“And the mountains will melt under him”

Micah is speaking of the effect of Yahweh’s powerful presence as if the solid **mountains will melt under him**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And it will be like the mountains will soften and flow out from beneath him]

See: Metaphor

Micah 1:4 (#2)

וְהָעֲמָקִים יִתְבַּקָּעוּ כַּדּוֹנַג מִפְּנֵי הָאֵשׁ כְּמַיִם מֻגָּרִים בְּמוֹרָד

“and the valleys will split open, like wax from the face of the fire, like waters poured down a steep place”

If it would be more natural in your language, you may want to put the comparisons of the wax and the water with the information about the mountains melting as modeled in the UST.

See: Information Structure

Micah 1:4 (#3)

כַּדּוֹנַג מִפְּנֵי הָאֵשׁ

“like wax from the face of the fire”

The point of this comparison is that just as **wax** melts when it is near a **fire**, so it will be as if the mountains will melt away because of the power of Yahweh’s presence. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [just as wax melts when it is near a fire]

See: Simile

Micah 1:4 (#4)

מִפְּנֵי הָאֵשׁ

“from the face of the fire”

Micah is using **from the face of** as a common expression of the culture to mean “because of” or “on account of.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [melts because of the heat of the fire]

See: Idiom

Micah 1:4 (#5)

כְּמַיִם מֻגָּרִים בְּמוֹרָד

“like waters poured down a steep place”

The point of this comparison is that just as **waters** rush swiftly and unstoppably down a **steep place**, so the will the mountains quickly melt before the powerful presence of Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [as swiftly and unstoppably as waters rushing down a steep place]

See: Simile

Micah 1:4 (#6)

כְּמַיִם מֻגָּרִים בְּמוֹרָד

“like waters poured down a steep place”

The expression **poured** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [like waters that pour down from a steep place]

See: Active or Passive

Micah 1:5 (#1)

בְּפֶ֣שַׁע יַעֲקֹ֔ב

“because of the transgression of Jacob”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **transgression**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [because of how Jacob has rebelled]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 1:5 (#2)

יַעֲקֹ֔ב

“Jacob”

Here Micah is using the name **Jacob** to refer to the people of Israel who were all descendants of the patriarch Jacob, who was also known as Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the people of Israel]

See: Metonymy

Micah 1:5 (#3)

בֵּ֖ית יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל

“the house of Israel”

Here, **house** means all the people descended from a particular person. It envisions them as if they were one household living together. So **the house of Israel** figuratively means all the people descended from the patriarch Jacob, who was also known as Israel. Alternate translation: [the Israelites]

See: Metaphor

Micah 1:5 (#4)

מִי־פֶ֣שַׁע יַעֲקֹ֗ב הֲלוֹא֙ שֹׁמְר֔וֹן

“Who {is} the transgression of Jacob? {Is} it not Samaria”

Micah is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Samaria is the cause of Jacob’s transgression!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Micah 1:5 (#5)

וּמִי֙ בָּמ֣וֹת יְהוּדָ֔ה הֲלֹ֖וא יְרוּשָׁלָֽ͏ִם

“And who {are} the high places of Judah? {Is} it not Jerusalem”

Micah is using the question form for emphasis. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [And Jerusalem lead Judah to worship idols on the high places!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Micah 1:6 (#1)

וְשַׂמְתִּ֥י

“So I will make”

This is the beginning of what Yahweh said. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this as a direct quotation. Alternate translation: [Yahweh said, “So I will make”]

See: Direct and Indirect Quotations

Micah 1:6 (#2)

לַגַּ֣י אֲבָנֶ֔יהָ וִיסֹדֶ֖יהָ

“her stones into the gorge, and her foundations”

The pronoun **her** refers to the city of Samaria, which Yahweh speaks of as if it were a woman. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Samaria’s stones into the gorge, and Samaria’s foundations]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 1:7 (#1)

וְכָל־פְּסִילֶ֖יהָ יֻכַּתּ֑וּ

“And all her carved images will be crushed”

The expression **crushed** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [And enemies will crush all Samaria’s carved images]

See: Active or Passive

Micah 1:7 (#2)

וְכָל־אֶתְנַנָּ֖יהָ יִשָּׂרְפ֣וּ בָאֵ֑שׁ

“and all her wages will be burned in the fire”

The expression **burned** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and fire will burn up all her wages]

See: Active or Passive

Micah 1:7 (#3)

אָשִׁשָׁיִם שָׂמְמָה

“I will make a desolation”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **desolation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [I will completely destroy]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 1:7 (#4)

יָשֻׁובוּ

“they will return”

The pronoun **they** refers to the idols and treasures that Samaria gathered. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [these treasures will be used again]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 1:8 (#1)

אֶסְפְּדָה וְאֵילִֽילָה

“I shall lament and wail”

The terms **lament** and **wail** mean similar things. Micah is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [I shall greatly mourn]

See: Doublet

Micah 1:8 (#2)

אֵילְכָה שׁוֹלֵל וְעָרֹום

“I shall go barefoot and naked”

Going about without sandals or clothing was a symbolic action by which Micah showed his deep grief and mourning over the coming disaster. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [I shall go barefoot and naked to show my grief]

See: Symbolic Action

Micah 1:8 (#3)

אֶעֱשֶׂה מִסְפֵּד כַּתַּנִּים

“I shall make a lamentation like the jackals”

The point of this comparison is that just as **the jackals** make loud, wailing cries, so Micah’s **lamentation** will be loud and mournful. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [I shall make a lamentation as loud and mournful as the cries of the jackals]

See: Simile

Micah 1:8 (#4)

מִסְפֵּד

“a lamentation”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **lamentation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [mournful wailing]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 1:8 (#5)

וְאֵבֶל כִּבְנוֹת יַעֲנָה

“and mourning like the daughters of an owl”

The point of this comparison is that just as **the daughters of an owl** make mournful, crying sounds, so Micah’s **mourning** will sound. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [and mourning that sounds like the crying of young owls]

See: Simile

Micah 1:8 (#6)

וְאֵבֶל כִּבְנוֹת יַעֲנָה

“and mourning like the daughters of an owl”

Micah is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and I shall make mourning like the daughters of an owl]

See: Ellipsis

Micah 1:8 (#7)

וְאֵבֶל

“and mourning”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **mourning**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and I shall mourn]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 1:9 (#1)

אֲנוּשָׁ֥ה מַכּוֹתֶ֖יהָ

“her wounds {are} incurable”

Micah is speaking of the destruction that has struck the city as if it were **wounds** that cannot be healed. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the destruction that struck her cannot be undone]

See: Metaphor

Micah 1:9 (#2)

מַכּוֹתֶ֖יהָ

“her wounds”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **wounds**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the places where she is wounded]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 1:9 (#3)

כִּי־בָ֣אָה עַד־יְהוּדָ֔ה נָגַ֖ע

“for it has come to Judah. It has reached”

The pronoun **it** refers to the disaster and judgment that Yahweh is bringing. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [for this disaster has also come to Judah. This disaster has reached]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 1:9 (#4)

שַׁ֥עַר עַמִּ֖י

“the gate of my people”

Here, **gate** represents the city of Jerusalem itself, since the gate was the main entrance to the city and the place where it was defended. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the city of my people]

See: Metonymy

Micah 1:10 (#1)

בְּגַ֣ת אַל־תַּגִּ֔ידוּ

“In Gath, do not declare {it”

The word translated as **declare** sounds like the name of the city, **Gath**. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could put this information in a footnote.

See: How to Translate Names

Micah 1:10 (#2)

אַל־תַּגִּ֔ידוּ

“do not declare {it”

The pronoun **it** refers to the news of the coming disaster. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [do not declare the news of the disaster]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 1:10 (#3)

בָּכֹ֖ו אַל־תִּבְכּ֑וּ

“weeping, do not weep”

Micah is repeating forms of the verb **weep** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [certainly you should not weep]

See: Reduplication

Micah 1:10 (#4)

בְּבֵ֣ית לְעַפְרָ֔ה עָפָ֖ר התפלשתי

“In Beth Leaphrah, roll yourself in the dust”

The name of the town **Beth Leaphrah** means “house of dust.” If it would be helpful to your readers, you could put this information in a footnote.

See: How to Translate Names

Micah 1:10 (#5)

עָפָ֖ר התפלשתי

“roll yourself in the dust”

Rolling oneself **in the dust** was a symbolic action by which a person showed deep grief and mourning. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [roll yourself in the dust to show your grief]

See: Symbolic Action

Micah 1:11 (#1)

שָׁפִ֥יר עֶרְיָֽה־בֹ֖שֶׁת לֹ֣א יָצְאָ֑ה יוֹשֶׁ֥בֶת צַאֲנָ֛ן מִסְפַּ֥ד בֵּֽית־הָאֵצֶ֖ל יִקַּ֥ח מִכֶּ֖ם

“Shaphir, {in} nakedness of shame. The dweller of Zaanan has not gone out; the mourning of Beth Ezel will take from you”

The name of the town **Shaphir** means “pleasant” or “beautiful,” the opposite of **nakedness** and **shame**. The name of the town **Zaanan** sounds like the verb “go out.” The name of the town **Beth Ezel** may mean “house of taking away.” If it would be helpful to your readers, you could put this information in a footnote.

Micah 1:11 (#2)

עֶרְיָה־בֹ֖שֶׁת

“in} nakedness of shame”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **shame**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [shamefully naked]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 1:11 (#3)

מִסְפַּ֥ד בֵּֽית־הָאֵצֶ֖ל

“the mourning of Beth Ezel”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **mourning**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [when the people of Beth Ezel mourn, it]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 1:11 (#4)

יִקַּ֥ח מִכֶּ֖ם עָמְדָּתֹֽו

“will take from you its standing place”

The pronoun **its** refers to the town of Beth Ezel. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [will take from you the standing place of Beth Ezel]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 1:12 (#1)

חָ֥לָה לְטֹ֖וב יוֹשֶׁ֣בֶת מָרֹ֑ות

“the dweller of Maroth writhes for {something} good”

The name of the town **Maroth** sounds like the word for “bitterness,” an opposite of **good.** If it would be helpful to your readers, you could put this information in a footnote.

See: How to Translate Names

Micah 1:12 (#2)

יָרַ֥ד רָעָ֛ה מֵאֵ֥ת יְהוָ֖ה

“evil has come down from Yahweh”

Micah is using the adjective **evil** as a noun to mean a certain kind of thing. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [terrible things have come down from Yahweh]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Micah 1:12 (#3)

לְשַׁ֥עַר יְרוּשָׁלִָֽם

“to the gate of Jerusalem”

Here, **the gate** represents the city of Jerusalem itself, since the gate was its main entrance. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [to Jerusalem itself]

See: Metonymy

Micah 1:13 (#1)

רְתֹ֤ם הַמֶּרְכָּבָה֙ לָרֶ֔כֶשׁ יוֹשֶׁ֖בֶת לָכִֽישׁ

“Harness the chariot to the steeds, dweller of Lachish”

The name of the town **Lachish** sounds like the word for “steed.” If it would be helpful to your readers, you could put this information in a footnote.

See: How to Translate Names

Micah 1:13 (#2)

רֵאשִׁ֥ית חַטָּ֖את הִ֣יא

“She {was} the beginning of sin”

Even though Micah has addressed the people of Lachish directly as **dweller of Lachish**, here he speaks of them in the third person as **She** and then switches back to addressing them as **you**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this consistently in the second person. Alternate translation: [You were the beginning of sin]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Micah 1:13 (#3)

לְבַת־צִיּוֹן

“to daughter Zion”

Micah is speaking of the city of Zion, that is, Jerusalem, and its people as if they were his **daughter**. This form of expression conveys affection. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [to my beloved people of Zion]

See: Metaphor

Micah 1:13 (#4)

בָּךְ נִמְצְאוּ

“in you were found”

The expression **were found** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [for people found in you]

See: Active or Passive

Micah 1:13 (#5)

פִּשְׁעֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the transgressions of Israel”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **transgressions**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the sinful things that Israel did]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 1:14 (#1)

לָכֵן

“Therefore”

The word translated as **Therefore** indicates that what follows is a result of what came before. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a result of what came before. Alternate translation: [As a result,]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Micah 1:14 (#2)

תִּתְּנִי שִׁלּוּחִים עַל מוֹרֶשֶׁת גַּת

“you will give dowry gifts to Moresheth Gath”

The town **Moresheth Gath** is Micah’s hometown. The part of the name **Moresheth** sounds like the word for “betrothed.” The idea is that, just as a father gave a gift of money (a dowry) along with his daughter to the man she married, the leaders of Jerusalem will have to give tribute to Assyria as they also give them their towns, such as Moresheth Gath.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Micah 1:14 (#3)

בָּתֵּי אַכְזִיבוּ לְאַכְזָב

“The houses of Achzib {will} become a deception”

The name of the town **Achzib** sounds like the word for “deception.” If it would be helpful to your readers, you could put this information in a footnote.

See: How to Translate Names

Micah 1:14 (#4)

לְאַכְזָב

“will} become a deception”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **deception**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [will turn out to be deceptive]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 1:15 (#1)

עֹד הַיֵּרֵשׁ אָבִיא לָךְ יוֹשֶׁבֶת מָרֵשָׁה

“Also a possessor I will bring to you, dweller of Mareshah”

The name of the town **Mareshah** sounds like the word for **possessor.** If it would be helpful to your readers, you could put this information in a footnote.

See: How to Translate Names

Micah 1:15 (#2)

כְּבוֹד יִשְׂרָאֵל

“The glory of Israel”

Here, **glory** represents the honored, important leaders of Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [honored ones of Israel]

See: Metonymy

Micah 1:15 (#3)

עַד־עֲדֻלָּם יָבוֹא כְּבוֹד יִשְׂרָאֵל

“The glory of Israel will come to Adullam”

By **The glory of Israel will come to Adullam**, Micah means that the honored leaders of Israel will go into hiding there, just as David once hid in the caves near Adullam to escape his enemies (described in 1 Samuel 22:1). You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Israel’s honored leaders will flee to hide in the caves near Adullam, as David once did]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Micah 1:15 (#4)

כְּבֹ֥וד יִשְׂרָאֵ֖ל

“The glory of Israel”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **glory**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [The glorious ones of Israel]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 1:16 (#1)

קָרְחִ֥י וְגֹּ֖זִּי

“Make yourself bald and shave”

The terms translated as **Make yourself bald** and **shave** mean similar things. Micah is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [Shave your head completely bald]

See: Doublet

Micah 1:16 (#2)

קָרְחִ֥י וְגֹּ֖זִּי

“Make yourself bald and shave”

Shaving the head completely bald was a symbolic action by which the people would show their deep grief and mourning. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [Make yourself bald and shave to show your grief]

See: Symbolic Action

Micah 1:16 (#3)

בְּנֵ֣י

“the sons of”

Here the masculine term **sons** has a generic sense that includes all children whether male or female. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use language in your translation that is clearly inclusive of both men and women as modeled in the UST.

See: When Masculine Words Include Women

Micah 1:16 (#4)

בְּנֵ֥י תַעֲנוּגָֽיִךְ

“the sons of your delight”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **delight**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the sons who delight you]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 1:16 (#5)

הַרְחִ֤בִי קָרְחָתֵךְ֙ כַּנָּ֔שֶׁר

“Enlarge your baldness like the eagle”

The point of this comparison is that just as **the eagle** has a bare, featherless head, so the people are to make their **baldness** in mourning complete. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [Make your baldness complete, so that your head is as bare as an eagle’s head]

See: Simile

Micah 1:16 (#6)

קָרְחָתֵךְ֙

“your baldness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **baldness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the bald area on your head]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 1:16 (#7)

כַּנָּ֔שֶׁר

“like the eagle”

This word could mean: (1) an eagle, or (2) a vulture. Alternate translation: [like the vulture]

Micah 1:16 (#8)

כִּֽי־גָלְל֥וּ מִמֵּֽךְ

“for they have gone into exile from you”

The pronoun **they** refers to the children whom Micah told the people to mourn for. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [for your children have gone into exile from you]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah - Chapter 2 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter continues using poetic forms in communicating that people who take advantage of others are guilty of sin and injustice.

1. Yahweh condemns those who oppress others (1–5)
2. Yahweh rebukes those who reject his word (6–11)
3. Yahweh promises to gather and restore his people (12–13)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Land as inheritance

A family's fields were an inheritance from Yahweh meant to stay in the family, so seizing them (verses 2, 4) violated covenant order and invited his judgment.

Micah 2:1 (#1)

הַהָוֹי חֹשְׁבֵי

"Woe to the devisers of"

Micah is using the word **Woe** to express a strong feeling of warning about the coming judgment on the people he is describing. There may be an equivalent word or phrase in your language that you can use in your translation to convey this feeling. Alternate translation: [Great disaster will come upon the devisers of]

See: Exclamations

Micah 2:1 (#2)

אָוֶן

"iniquity"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **iniquity**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [what is sinful]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 2:1 (#3)

וּפֹעֲלֵי רָעָ֔ה

"and the workers of evil"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **evil**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and those who plan to do evil deeds]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 2:1 (#4)

בְּאוֹר הַבֹּ֖קֶר יַעֲשׂוּהָ כִּֽי־יֶשׁ־לְאֵ֥ל יָדָֽם

"In the light of the morning they do it, for it is in the power of their hand"

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Because it is in the power of their hand, in the light of the morning they do it]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Micah 2:1 (#5)

לְאֵ֥ל יָדָֽם

"in the power of their hand"

Here, **their hand** represents their ability to do what they want. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [within their power to do so]

See: Metonymy

Micah 2:2 (#1)

וְחָמְד֣וּ שָׂדוֹת֮ וְגָזָ֣לוּ וּבָתִּ֒ים וְנָשָׂ֑אוּ

"And they covet & and seize {them"

Micah is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Woe to those who covet fields and seize them and covet houses and take them away]

See: Ellipsis

Micah 2:2 (#2)

וְעָשְׁקוּ֙ גֶּ֣בֶר וּבֵיתֹ֔ו וְאִ֖ישׁ וְנַחֲלָתֹֽו

"and his house, and a man and his inheritance"

Micah is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [And they oppress a man and take away

his house, and they oppress a man and take away his inheritance]

See: Ellipsis

Micah 2:2 (#3)

וְנַחֲלָתֹו

“and his inheritance”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **inheritance**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [his inherited property]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 2:3 (#1)

לָכֵן

“Therefore”

The term translated as **Therefore** indicates that what follows is a result of what came before. This marks the shift from the previous accusations to the sentence or judgement about to be pronounced. Use a connector in your language that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [Because you do these things]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Micah 2:3 (#2)

הִנְנִי חֹשֵׁשֵׁב

“Behold me, devising”

Yahweh is using **Behold me** as a common expression to mean that he is about to act. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I am about to devise]

See: Idiom

Micah 2:3 (#3)

הַמִּשְׁפָּחָה הַזֹּאת

“this clan”

Yahweh is using one part of the nation, **this clan** to represent all the people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [all of you]

See: Synecdoche

Micah 2:3 (#4)

אֲשֶׁר לֹא־תָמִישׁוּ מִשָּׁם צַוְּארֹתֵיכֶם

“which you will not remove your necks from there”

Yahweh is speaking of the coming disaster as if it were a heavy yoke on the people, from which **you will not remove your necks**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from which you will not be able to free yourselves]

See: Metaphor

Micah 2:3 (#5)

וְלֹא תֵלְכוּ רוֹמָה

“and you will not walk haughtily”

Yahweh is speaking of behaving or conducting oneself as if it were walking down a path. To **walk haughtily** means to behave arrogantly or proudly. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you will not conduct yourselves proudly]

See: Metaphor

Micah 2:4 (#1)

בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא

“In that day”

Micah is using the phrase translated as **In that day** to introduce a new event. Use a word, phrase, or other method in your language that is natural for introducing a new event.

See: Introduction of a New Event

Micah 2:4 (#2)

יִשָּׂא עֲלֵיכֶם מָשָׁל

“someone} will lift up against you a proverb”

Here the word **someone** refers to the enemies of the people in general, not to any specific person. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [your enemy will lift up against you a proverb]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 2:4 (#3)

וְנָהָה נְהִי נְהִיָה

“and lament a lamentation of a lamentation”

Micah is repeating forms of the word **lament** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [and mock you with a mournful dirge]

See: Reduplication

Micah 2:4 (#4)

שָׁדֹד נְשַׁדֵּדְנוּ

“Destroying, we are destroyed”

The people are repeating forms of the same verb, **Destroying** and **we are destroyed**, in order to intensify their expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [We are utterly destroyed]

See: Reduplication

Micah 2:4 (#5)

נְשַׁדֵּדְנוּ

“we are destroyed”

The expression **we are destroyed** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Yahweh has destroyed us]

See: Active or Passive

Micah 2:4 (#6)

חֵלֶק עַמִּי

“The portion of my people”

Micah assumes that readers will know that the phrase **portion of my people** means the fields and property that Yahweh gave to his people as their inheritance. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [The land that my people inherited]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Micah 2:4 (#7)

אֵיךְ יָמִישׁ

“How he removes {it”

The people are using a phrase that expresses a strong feeling of dismay and grief at their loss. There may be an equivalent word or phrase in your language that you can use in your translation to convey this feeling. Alternate translation: [Alas, he removes my portion]

See: Exclamations

Micah 2:5 (#1)

לָכֵן

“Therefore”

The term translated as **Therefore** indicates that what follows is a future result of the redistribution of their land. Use a connector in your language that makes this clear. Alternate translation: [As a result,]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Micah 2:5 (#2)

מַשְׁלִיךְ חֶבֶל בְּגוֹרָל

“one casting a measuring line by lot”

Micah assumes that readers will know that **casting a measuring line by lot** refers to the way the tribes received the land in Numbers 26:55. Since Yahweh had promised Abraham the land as an eternal inheritance, Micah knew they would some day return from exile and the land would once again be divided up, but those who Yahweh is judging here will not be a part of that. You could say that explicitly as in the UST if that would be helpful to your readers.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Micah 2:5 (#3)

בִּקְהַל יְהוָה

“in the assembly of Yahweh”

Micah is using the possessive form to mean the **assembly** that belongs to **Yahweh,** that is, when his people gather once again to divide up the land after returning from exile. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [among Yahweh’s people]

See: Possession

Micah 2:6 (#1)

אַל־תַּטִּפוּ יַטִּיפֻן

“Do not drip,” they drip”

The pronoun **they** refers to the false prophets who oppose Micah. It may be helpful to clarify this for your

readers. Alternate translation: [“Do not drip,” the false prophets drip]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 2:6 (#2)

אַל־תַּטִּפוּ יַטִּיפֻן לֹא־יַטִּפוּ

“Do not drip,” they drip. They do not drip”

Micah is speaking of prophesying as if it were words that **drip** from the prophet’s mouth, letting words fall like rain. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [“Do not pour out words of prophecy,” the false prophets prophesy. They do not prophesy]

See: Metaphor

Micah 2:6 (#3)

לֹ֣א יִסַּ֔ג כְּלִמֹּ֖ות

“disgraces will not depart”

Here Micah is speaking of **disgraces** as if they were living things that could **depart**, or leave on their own. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [they will always be disgraced]

See: Personification

Micah 2:7 (#1)

הֶאָמְמ֣וּר בֵּ֔ית־יַעֲקֹ֖ב

“Should it be said, house of Jacob”

Micah is using the question form to rebuke the people for the complacent things they say. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [It should not be said, house of Jacob]

See: Rhetorical Question

Micah 2:7 (#2)

הֶאָמְמ֣וּר

“Should it be said”

The expression **Should it be said** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [Should anyone say]

See: Active or Passive

Micah 2:7 (#3)

בֵּ֔ית־יַעֲקֹ֖ב

“house of Jacob”

Here, **house** means all the people descended from a particular person. It envisions them as if they were one household living together. So **the house of Jacob** figuratively means all the people descended from the patriarch Jacob, who was also known as Israel. Alternate translation: [you Israelites]

See: Metaphor

Micah 2:7 (#4)

הֲקֻצַּ֥ר רוּחַ֙ יְהוָ֔ה

“Is the Spirit of Yahweh short”

Here Micah is speaking of Yahweh being impatient as if his Spirit could be **short**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Is Yahweh impatient]

See: Metaphor

Micah 2:7 (#5)

הֲקֻצַּ֥ר רוּחַ֙ יְהוָ֔ה

“Is the Spirit of Yahweh short”

Micah is using the question form to affirm that the Spirit of Yahweh is not impatient. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [The Spirit of Yahweh is not impatient!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Micah 2:7 (#6)

אֵ֖אֶלֶּה מַעֲלָלָֽיו

“Are these his deeds”

Micah is using the question form to affirm that such calamities are not the kind of thing Yahweh normally does. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [These are not his deeds!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Micah 2:7 (#7)

אֵ֖אֶלֶּה מַעֲלָלָֽיו

“Are these his deeds”

The pronoun **his** refers to Yahweh. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Are these Yahweh's deeds]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 2:7 (#8)

הֲלֹלְוֹא דְבָרַי יֵיטִיבוּ עִעִם הַיָּשָׁר הוֹלֵךְ

"Do not my words do good with the one walking uprightly"

Micah is using the question form to affirm that his words which are reflecting Yahweh's words do good to those who live uprightly. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Surely my words do good with the one walking uprightly.]

See: Rhetorical Question

Micah 2:7 (#9)

הַיָּשָׁר הוֹלֵךְ

"the one walking uprightly"

Micah is speaking of living or conducting one's life as if it were **walking**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the one who lives righteously]

See: Metaphor

Micah 2:8 (#1)

וְאֶתְמוֹל עַמִּי

"But recently my people"

This is likely the beginning of what Yahweh said. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could mark that this is a direct quote of Yahweh as modeled in the UST.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Micah 2:8 (#2)

עַמִּי לְאוֹיֵב יְקוֹמֵמָם

"my people rise up as an enemy"

The pronoun **my** refers to Yahweh, who begins speaking here about his own people. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Yahweh's people rise up as an enemy]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 2:8 (#3)

עַמִּי לְאוֹיֵב יְקוֹמֵמָם

"my people rise up as an enemy"

The point of this comparison is that just as **an enemy** rises up to attack, so the leaders of Israel who Yahweh calls **my people**, have turned against Yahweh and have attacked their own defenseless people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [my people attack the way an enemy would attack]

See: Simile

Micah 2:8 (#4)

תַּפְשִׁטוּן

"You strip"

The pronoun **You** here and in the next verse, refers to the leaders of the Israelite people whom Yahweh has just described as rising up as an enemy against their own people. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [You leaders of my people strip]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 2:8 (#5)

אֶאֶדֶר

"the splendor"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **splendor**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the most splendid part]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 2:9 (#1)

מִבָּתֵּי תַּעֲנֻגֶּיהָ מֵעַל עֹלְלֶיהָ

"from the house of her delights; from upon her infants"

The pronoun **her** refers to each of the women among Yahweh's people whom the leaders are oppressing. He is not speaking about one particular woman but all of the women. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [from the houses of their delights; from upon their infants]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 2:9 (#2)

תַּעֲנֻגֶּיהָ

“her delights”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **delights**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [that she delights in]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 2:9 (#3)

הֲדָרִי

“my splendor”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **splendor**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the splendid things I gave them]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 2:10 (#1)

הַמְּנוּחָה

“the resting place”

Here Micah is speaking of the land where the people can safely live as if it were a **resting place**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the place where you can safely live]

See: Metaphor

Micah 2:10 (#2)

טָמְאָה

“uncleanness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **uncleanness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [being unclean]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 2:10 (#3)

תְּחַבֵּל

“it will destroy”

The phrase **it will destroy** is a translation of the standard written Hebrew text. This reading, however, does not seem to make sense. You may want to follow an alternative reading that scholars have proposed was original, pronouncing the consonants with different vowels. Alternate translation: [it will be destroyed]

See: Alternative Readings

Micah 2:10 (#4)

תְּחַבֵּבָל

“it will destroy”

The pronoun **it** refers to the uncleanness of the land, which brings about its destruction. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the land will be destroyed]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 2:10 (#5)

וְחֶבֶל נִמְרֶץ

“and a grievous destruction”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **destruction**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and I will destroy it very severely]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 2:11 (#1)

לוּ־אִישׁ הֹלֵךְ רוּחַ וְשֶׁקֶר כִּזַּב

“If a man walking {in} wind and falsehood lied”

Micah is presenting a possible condition, that a person might come speaking lies and promising indulgence. Use a natural form in your language for introducing a condition that could happen. Alternate translation: [Suppose a man walking in wind and falsehood lied]

See: Connect — Hypothetical Conditions

Micah 2:11 (#2)

אִישׁ הֹלֵךְ

“a man walking”

Micah is speaking of a person conducting his life as if it were **walking** down a path. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [a man who lives]

See: Metaphor

Micah 2:11 (#3)

אִישׁ

“a man”

Micah is not referring to a specific **man**. He means anyone in general. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be

more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [anyone]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Micah 2:11 (#4)

רֽוּחַ֙ וְשֶׁ֣קֶר

“in} wind and falsehood”

Micah is speaking of empty, deceptive speech as **wind** with no substance. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [by empty, deceptive talk]

See: Metaphor

Micah 2:11 (#5)

רֽוּחַ֙ וְשֶׁ֣קֶר

“in} wind and falsehood”

The phrase **wind and falsehood** expresses a single idea. The word **wind** tells more about **falsehood**, describing it as empty and worthless. If it would be more natural in your language, you could express this meaning in a different way. Alternate translation: [in worthless lies]

See: Hendiadys

Micah 2:11 (#6)

וְשֶׁ֣קֶר

“and falsehood”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **falsehood**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and speaking false things]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 2:11 (#7)

אַטִּ֥ף לְךָ֖ לַיַּ֑יִן וְלַשֵּׁכָ֔ר

“I will drip to you of wine and of beer”

Here the false prophet is speaking of someone who prophesies or preaches as if his words would **drip** out of his mouth as if they would fall like rain, as in verse 6. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I will prophesy to you about wine and beer]

See: Metaphor

Micah 2:11 (#8)

וְהָיָ֥ה מַטִּ֖יף הָעָ֥ם הַזֶּֽה

“he would be the dripper of this people”

Micah is speaking of the false prophet speaking these prophesies that the people want to hear as if he were the **dripper** whose words would fall like rain. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [he would be exactly the sort of prophet this people would welcome]

See: Metaphor

Micah 2:12 (#1)

אָסֹ֤ף אֶאֱסֹף֙

“Gathering, I will gather”

Yahweh is repeating forms of the verb **gather**, in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [I will certainly gather]

See: Reduplication

Micah 2:12 (#2)

יַעֲקֹ֔ב

“Jacob”

Yahweh is using Jacob, the patriarch, who was also known as Israel, to represent all of his descendants. Alternate translation: [the people of Israel]

See: Synecdoche

Micah 2:12 (#3)

קַבֵּ֥ץ אֶקַבֵּ֖יץ

“Assembling, I will assemble”

Yahweh is repeating forms of the verb **assemble**, in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [I will surely assemble]

See: Reduplication

Micah 2:12 (#4)

שְׁאֵרִ֣ית יִשְׂרָאֵ֔ל

“the remnant of Israel”

Yahweh is using the possessive form to describe the **remnant** that consists of the people of **Israel** who survive. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the remaining people of Israel]

See: Possession

Micah 2:12 (#5)

אֲשִׁיתֵֽמֵנּוּ

“I will set them”

Even though Yahweh is addressing the people directly earlier in this verse, here he speaks about them in the third person as **them**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could continue to use the second person here. Alternate translation: [I will set you all]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Micah 2:12 (#6)

כְּצֹ֣אן בָּצְרָ֗ה כְּעֶדֶר֙ בְּתוֹךְ֙ הַדְּבִרֹ֔ו

“like sheep of Bozrah, like a flock in the midst of its pasture”

The point of this comparison is that just as **sheep** are gathered together safely into **a flock** within their **pasture**, so Yahweh will gather his people together. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [like sheep of Bozrah gathered safely together, like a flock kept secure within its pasture]

See: Simile

Micah 2:13 (#1)

הַפֹּרֵ֣ץ

“The breaker”

Here Yahweh is speaking of the leader who goes ahead of the people as if he were **The breaker**, one who breaks open a way through a barrier. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The one who breaks through]

See: Metaphor

Micah 2:13 (#2)

עָלָ֥ה & לִפְנֵיהֶ֖ם

“has gone up to the face of them”

Here, **to the face of them** represents being in front of them or ahead of them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [has gone up in front of them]

See: Metonymy

Micah 2:13 (#3)

וַיַּעֲבֹ֤ר מַלְכָּם֙ לִפְנֵיהֶ֔ם

“And their king has passed on to the face of them”

Here again, **to the face of them** represents being in front of them, leading them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And their king has gone ahead of them]

See: Metonymy

Micah 2:13 (#4)

וַיהוָ֖ה בְּרֹאשָֽׁם

“and Yahweh {is} at their head”

Here, **their head** represents the leading or foremost position. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and Yahweh leads the way]

See: Metonymy

Micah - Chapter 3 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Yahweh judges corrupt leaders and false prophets.

1. Yahweh condemns the injustice of Israel’s leaders (1–4)
2. Yahweh exposes the deception of false prophets (5–8)
3. Yahweh announces judgment on Jerusalem’s rulers (9–12)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Justice

An unjust society was considered to be against the law of Moses. If these kingdoms did not have justice, they were not obedient to Yahweh.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Metaphors

There are vivid pictures used in this chapter which show how the leaders of the people were treating the

Israelites. These situations are absurd unless taken as a metaphor.

Micah 3:1 (#1)

וָאֹמַר

“And I said”

Micah is using the words **And I said** to introduce a direct quotation of what he said to the leaders. In your translation, use a natural way of introducing direct quotations in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Micah 3:1 (#2)

רָאשֵׁי יַעֲקֹב

“heads of Jacob”

Here, **heads** represents the leaders of the people and the name **Jacob** the people of Israel who were all descendants of the patriarch Jacob, who was also known as Israel.. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [leaders of the people of Israel]

See: Metonymy

Micah 3:1 (#3)

בֵּית יִשְׂרָאֵל

“the house of Israel”

Here, **house** means all the people descended from a particular person. It envisions them as if they were one household living together. So **the house of Israel** figuratively means all the people descended from the patriarch Jacob, who was also known as Israel. Alternate translation: [the people of Israel]

See: Metaphor

Micah 3:1 (#4)

הֲלוֹא לָכֶם לָדַעַת אֶת־הַמִּשְׁפָּט

“Is it not for you to know justice”

Micah is using the question form to rebuke the leaders and to assert that they are obligated to know justice. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [It is certainly your responsibility to know justice!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Micah 3:1 (#5)

אֶת־הַמִּשְׁפָּט

“justice”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **justice**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [how to act justly]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 3:2 (#1)

טֹטְוֹב וְאֹהֲבֵי רעה

“good and lovers of evil”

Micah is using the adjectives **good** and **evil** as nouns to mean certain kinds of actions. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [doing good things and love doing evil things]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Micah 3:2 (#2)

גֹּזְלֵי עוֹרָם מֵעֲלֵיהֶם וּשְׁאָרָם מֵעַל עַצְמוֹתָם

“tearing their skin from upon them and their flesh from upon their bones”

Here Micah is speaking of the way the leaders oppress the people as if the leaders were butchers **tearing their skin from upon them and their flesh from upon their bones**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [brutally oppressing the people, taking everything they have]

See: Metaphor

Micah 3:2 (#3)

עוֹרָם מֵעֲלֵיהֶם וּשְׁאָרָם מֵעַל עַצְמוֹתָם

“their skin from upon them and their flesh from upon their bones”

The pronouns **their** and **them** refer to the victims of the leaders’ oppression. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the people’s skin from upon them and the people’s flesh from upon their bones]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 3:2 (#4)

וּשְׁאָרָם מֵעַל עַצְמוֹתָם

“and their flesh from upon their bones”

Micah is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and tearing their flesh from upon their bones]

See: Ellipsis

Micah 3:3 (#1)

וַאֲשֶׁ֥ר אָכְל֖וּ שְׁאֵ֥ר עַמִּֽי׃

“and who have eaten the flesh of my people”

Here Micah is speaking of the way the leaders exploit the people as if the leaders had **eaten the flesh of my people**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and who have exploited my people]

See: Metaphor

Micah 3:3 (#2)

וְעוֹרָ֣ם ׀ מֵעֲלֵיהֶ֣ם הִפְשִׁ֔יטוּ וְאֶת־עַצְמֹתֵיהֶ֖ם פִּצֵּֽחוּ

“and their skin from upon them they have stripped, and their bones they have broken”

Here Micah is speaking of how the leaders oppress the people as if the leaders had stripped **their skin from upon them** and had broken **their bones**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they have cruelly oppressed and crushed them]

See: Metaphor

Micah 3:3 (#3)

הִפְשִׁ֔יטוּ וְאֶת־עַצְמֹתֵיהֶ֖ם פִּצֵּ֑חוּ וּפָרְשׁ֗וּ

“they have stripped, and their bones they have broken, and they have chopped {them} up”

Even though Micah is addressing the leaders of Israel directly (see 3:1), here he is speaking of them in the third person as **they**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the second person for consistency. Alternate translation: [you have stripped, and their bones you have broken, and you have chopped them up]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Micah 3:3 (#4)

וּפָרְשׁ֗וּ כַּאֲשֶׁ֤ר בַּסִּיר֙ וּכְבָשָׂ֔ר בְּת֖וֹךְ קִלָּֽחַת

“and they have chopped {them} up as {what} is in the pot, and as flesh inside a cauldron”

The point of this comparison is that the leaders treat the people as cruelly as a cook treats the meat that he chops up to cook **as what is in the pot** and **as flesh inside a cauldron**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [and they have chopped them up as cruelly as a cook chops up the meat that goes in the pot and the flesh inside a cauldron]

See: Simile

Micah 3:3 (#5)

וּכְבָשָׂ֔ר בְּת֖וֹךְ קִלָּֽחַת

“and as flesh inside a cauldron”

Micah is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and as they chopped up the flesh to cook inside a cauldron]

See: Ellipsis

Micah 3:4 (#1)

אָ֣ז

“Then”

The word **Then** indicates that these events will take place at a later time, after the wrongdoing described in the previous verses. Your language may have a connecting phrase that you can use to show this. Alternate translation: [At a later time]

See: Connect — Sequential Time Relationship

Micah 3:4 (#2)

וְיַסְתֵּ֤ר פָּנָיו֙ מֵהֶ֣ם ׀ בָּעֵ֣ת הַהִ֔יא כַּאֲשֶׁ֥ר הֵרֵ֖עוּ מַעַלְלֵיהֶֽם

“And he will hide his face from them at that time, just as they have made their deeds evil”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Since they have made their deeds evil, he will hide his face from them at that time.]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Micah 3:4 (#3)

יִזְעֲקוּ

“they will cry out”

The pronoun **they** refers to the leaders whom Micah has just finished addressing. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the leaders will cry out]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 3:4 (#4)

וְיַסְתֵּ֤ר פָּנָיו֙ מֵהֶ֔ם

“And he will hide his face from them”

The pronouns **he** and **his** refer to Yahweh, and the pronoun **them** refers to the leaders. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh will hide his face from those leaders]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 3:4 (#5)

וְיַסְתֵּ֤ר פָּנָיו֙ מֵהֶ֔ם

“And he will hide his face from them”

Here, **his face** represents Yahweh’s favorable attention, so that to **hide his face** means to refuse to help. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And he will refuse to help them]

See: Metonymy

Micah 3:5 (#1)

כֹּ֚ה אָמַ֣ר יְהוָ֔ה

“Thus says Yahweh”

Micah is using the words **Thus says Yahweh** to indicate that what follows is a direct quotation from Yahweh and comes with Yahweh’s authority. In your translation, use a natural way of indicating direct quotations in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Micah 3:5 (#2)

הַמַּתְעִ֣עִים אֶת־עַמִּ֔י

“causing my people to wander astray”

Yahweh is speaking of the prophets leading the people into wrong belief and behavior as if the prophets were **causing** the people **to wander astray** from the right path. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [causing my people to believe and act wrongly]

See: Metaphor

Micah 3:5 (#3)

הַנֹּשְׁכִ֤ים בְּשִׁנֵּיהֶם֙ וְקָרְא֣וּ שָׁל֔וֹם

“biting with their teeth, then they call out, ‘Peace”

Yahweh is speaking of the practice the prophets had of giving a favorable prophecy to someone in exchange for food or payment as if they were **biting with their teeth**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [when they have been given food to eat, then they call out, ‘Peace!’]

See: Metaphor

Micah 3:5 (#4)

שָׁל֔וֹם

“Peace”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **Peace**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [You will live peacefully and be safe]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 3:5 (#5)

וְקִדְּשׁ֥וּ עָלָ֖יו מִלְחָמָֽה

“they consecrate war against him”

The implication is that the prophets perform religious ceremonies to declare a holy war against anyone who does not feed them. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [they perform ceremonies to declare a holy war against him]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Micah 3:5 (#6)

וְקִדְּשׁ֥וּ עָלָ֖יו מִלְחָמָֽה

“they consecrate war against him”

The pronoun **they** refers to the prophets, and the pronoun **him** refers to anyone who does not give the prophets food. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the prophets consecrate war against that person]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 3:6 (#1)

לָכֵ֣ן

“Therefore”

The word **Therefore** indicates that what follows is the sentence for the crime the prophets are being accused of in the previous verse. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a result. Alternate translation: [Because you have done these things]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Micah 3:6 (#2)

לַ֤יְלָה לָכֶם֙ מֵחָזֹ֔ון

“it will be} night for you without vision”

Here Yahweh is speaking of the prophets losing their ability to receive revelation as if they would become blind, saying it would become **night for you**, a time **without vision**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you prophets will receive no more visions]

See: Metaphor

Micah 3:6 (#3)

מֵחָזֹ֔ון

“without vision”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **vision**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [without the ability to see visions]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 3:6 (#4)

וְחָשְׁכָ֥ה לָכֶ֖ם מִקֶּ֑סֶם

“and it will be dark for you without divining”

Yahweh assumes that readers will know **divining** refers to the pagan practice these prophets used to predict the future. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and you will lose the ability you claim you have to predict the future]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Micah 3:6 (#5)

וּבָ֣אָה הַשֶּׁ֔מֶשׁ עַל־הַנְּבִיאִ֖ים וְקָדַ֣ר עֲלֵיהֶ֑ם הַיֹּ֖ום

“And the sun will go down on the prophets, and the day will become dark over them”

Yahweh is speaking of the prophets losing his favor and guidance and the gift of true prophesy as if the **sun will go down on the prophets**, and **the day will become dark over them**, leaving them in darkness. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And the prophets will lose my guidance and the ability to see my revelation]

See: Metaphor

Micah 3:6 (#6)

עַל־הַנְּבִיאִ֖ים וְקָדַ֣ר עֲלֵיהֶ֑ם הַיֹּ֖ום

“on the prophets, and the day will become dark over them”

Even though Yahweh is addressing the prophets directly, here he is speaking of them in the third person as **the prophets** and **them**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in a respectful form in the second person. Alternate translation: [on you prophets, and the day will become dark over you]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Micah 3:7 (#1)

וְחָפְר֥וּ הַקֹּסְמִ֖ים

“and the diviners will be disgraced”

The expression **will be disgraced** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and the diviners will no longer have honor from the people because they are unable to predict the future]

See: Active or Passive

Micah 3:7 (#2)

וְעָטְו֣וּ עַל־שָׂפָ֔ם כֻּלָּ֖ם

“And all of them will cover over the mustache”

Covering the upper lip, represented here by **cover over the mustache**, was a symbolic action by which people showed that they were unclean or in mourning. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [And all of

them will cover their upper lip to express their sorrow and shame]

See: Symbolic Action

Micah 3:7 (#3)

מַעֲנֵנָה אֱלֹהִים

“answer of God”

Here Micah is using the possessive form to describe an **answer** that comes from **God**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [answer from God]

See: Possession

Micah 3:8 (#1)

וְאוּלָם אָנֹכִי מָלֵאתִי

“But I, in contrast, I am full of”

Micah uses the words **But** and **in contrast** here to indicate a contrast between the false prophets, who will be put to shame, and himself, who is empowered by the Spirit of Yahweh. In your translation, indicate this contrast in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [I, however, am full of]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Micah 3:8 (#2)

וְאוּלָם אָנֹכִי מָלֵאתִי

“But I, in contrast, I am full of”

Micah is stating the pronoun **I** separately, even though the verb translated as **I am full** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize how he is different from the other prophets mentioned previously. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [In contrast to them, I am full]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 3:8 (#3)

כֹּ֚חַ אֶת־רוּחַ֙ יְהוָ֔ה וּמִשְׁפָּ֖ט וּגְבוּרָֽה

“power, the Spirit of Yahweh, and justice, and might”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **power**, **justice**, and **might**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [what makes me strong, the Spirit of Yahweh, and what makes me just and mighty]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 3:8 (#4)

אֶת־רוּחַ֙ יְהוָ֔ה

“the Spirit of Yahweh”

Here Micah is using the possessive form to describe the **Spirit** that comes from and belongs to **Yahweh**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the Spirit that comes from Yahweh]

See: Possession

Micah 3:8 (#5)

אֶת־רוּחַ֙ יְהוָ֔ה

“the Spirit of Yahweh”

Micah is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You could supply these words if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [I am full of the Spirit of Yahweh]

See: Ellipsis

Micah 3:8 (#6)

לְהַגִּ֤יד לְיַעֲקֹב֙ פִּשְׁעֹ֔ו וּלְיִשְׂרָאֵ֖ל חַטָּאתֹֽו

“to declare to Jacob his transgression, and to Israel his sin”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [to declare to the people of Israel how thy have rebelled by sinning again God]

See: Parallelism

Micah 3:8 (#7)

פִּשְׁעֹ֔ו וּלְיִשְׂרָאֵ֖ל חַטָּאתֹֽו

“his transgression, and to Israel his sin”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **transgression** and **sin**, you could express the same ideas in other ways. Alternate translation: [about how he has rebelled and to Israel about how he has sinned]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 3:8 (#8)

וּלְיִשְׂרָאֵ֖ל חַטָּאתֹֽו

“and to Israel his sin”

Micah is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. It may be helpful to repeat some of these words from the previous phrase. Alternate translation: [and to declare to Israel his sin]

See: Ellipsis

Micah 3:9 (#1)

רָאשֵׁי֙ בֵּ֣ית יַעֲקֹ֔ב וּקְצִינֵ֖י בֵּ֣ית יִשְׂרָאֵ֑ל

“heads of the house of Jacob and commanders of the house of Israel”

See how you translated the very similar phrases in verse1.

See: Metonymy

Micah 3:9 (#2)

מִשְׁפָּֽט

“justice”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **justice**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [what is just]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 3:9 (#3)

וְאֵ֥ת כָּל־הַיְשָׁרָ֖ה יְעַקֵּֽשׁוּ

“and making all of the straight {things} crooked”

Here Micah is speaking of what is morally right as if it were **straight**, and of corrupting it as if it were making it **crooked**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [corrupting everything that is right]

See: Metaphor

Micah 3:10 (#1)

בֹּנֶ֥ה צִיּ֖וֹן בְּדָמִ֑ים וִירוּשָׁלַ֖ם בְּעַוְלָֽה

“building Zion with bloodshed and Jerusalem with injustice”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Another approach would be to connect the phrases with a word that shows that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. See how you as a team have decided to translate the parallel phrases in poetry, and follow that approach here and throughout this chapter. Alternate translation: [building Zion with bloodshed, indeed, building Jerusalem with injustice]

See: Parallelism

Micah 3:10 (#2)

וִירוּשָׁלַ֖ם בְּעַוְלָֽה

“and Jerusalem with injustice”

Micah is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and building Jerusalem with injustice]

See: Ellipsis

Micah 3:10 (#3)

בְּעַוְלָֽה

“with injustice”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **injustice**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [by doing what is unjust]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 3:11 (#1)

רָאשֶׁ֣יהָ ׀ בְּשֹׁ֣חַד יִשְׁפֹּ֔טוּ וְכֹהֲנֶ֖יהָ בִּמְחִ֣יר יוֹרֽוּ׃ וּנְבִיאֶ֖יהָ בְּכֶ֣סֶף יְקֹסֵ֑מוּ וְעַל־יְהוָה֙ יִשָּׁעֵ֣נוּ

“Her heads judge for a bribe, and her priests teach for a price, and her prophets divine for silver. Yet they lean on Yahweh”

Even though Micah has been addressing the various leaders of Jerusalem directly, here he is speaking of them in the third person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the second person for consistency. Alternate translation: [You leaders judge for a bribe, and you priests teach for a price, and you prophets divine for silver. Yet you lean on Yahweh]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Micah 3:11 (#2)

רָאשֶׁ֙יהָ ׀ בְּשֹׁ֣חַד יִשְׁפֹּ֔טוּ

“Her heads judge for a bribe”

Here, **heads** represents the leaders of the city. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [Her leaders judge for a bribe]

See: Metonymy

Micah 3:11 (#3)

רָאשֶׁ֙יהָ

“Her heads”

The pronoun **Her** refers to the city of Jerusalem. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Jerusalem’s heads]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 3:11 (#4)

וְעַל־יְהוָ֥ה יִשָּׁעֵ֖נוּ

“Yet they lean on Yahweh”

The pronoun **they** refers to the leaders, priests, and prophets of the city. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Yet these same leaders, priests, and prophets lean on Yahweh]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 3:11 (#5)

וְעַל־יְהוָ֥ה יִשָּׁעֵ֖נוּ

“Yet they lean on Yahweh”

Here Micah is speaking of trusting in Yahweh for support as if the people could physically **lean on Yahweh**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yet they claim to rely on Yahweh]

See: Metaphor

Micah 3:11 (#6)

הֲלֹ֥וֹא יְהוָ֖ה בְּקִרְבֵּ֑נוּ

“Is not Yahweh in our midst”

The leaders are using the question form to express their confidence that Yahweh is present with them and will protect them. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Surely Yahweh is in our midst!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Micah 3:12 (#1)

לָכֵ֗ן בִּגְלַלְכֶ֛ם

“Therefore, because of you”

The word **Therefore** indicates that what follows is the sentence for the crime the leaders are being accused of in the previous verses. Use a connector in your language that makes it clear that what follows is a result. Alternate translation: [Because you have done these things]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Micah 3:12 (#2)

בִּגְלַלְכֶ֛ם

“because of you”

The pronoun **you** refers to the leaders, priests, and prophets of the city. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [because of you leaders, priests, and prophets]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 3:12 (#3)

צִיּ֥וֹן שָׂדֶ֖ה תֵּחָרֵ֣שׁ וִירוּשָׁלַ֗͏ִם עִיִּ֤ין תִּהְיֶה֙ וְהַ֣הַר הַבַּ֔יִת לְבָמ֖וֹת יָֽעַר

“Zion will be plowed {as} a field, and Jerusalem will become heaps, and the mountain of the house, as high places of a forest”

See how you translated these phrases quoted in Jeremiah 26:18.

Micah 3:12 (#4)

צִיּ֥וֹן שָׂדֶ֖ה תֵּחָרֵ֣שׁ

“Zion will be plowed {as} a field”

The point of this comparison is that Zion, or Jerusalem will be so completely destroyed that the ground where the city stood will be **plowed** like an open **field**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [Zion will be so completely leveled that it will be like a plowed field]

See: Simile

Micah 3:12 (#5)

צִיּ֥וֹן שָׂדֶ֖ה תֵּחָרֵ֣שׁ

“Zion will be plowed {as} a field”

The expression **will be plowed** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you must state who does the action, it is the enemies of Zion who will plow it. Alternate translation: [your enemies will plow Zion like a field]

See: Active or Passive

Micah 3:12 (#6)

וְהַהַ֥ר הַבַּ֖יִת לְבָמֹ֥ות יָֽעַר

“and the mountain of the house, as high places of a forest”

Micah is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and the mountain of the house will become as high places of a forest]

See: Ellipsis

Micah 3:12 (#7)

וְהַהַ֥ר הַבַּ֖יִת

“and the mountain of the house”

Here Micah is speaking of the temple as if it were a **house**, since it was the place where Yahweh was present among his people. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the temple mountain]

See: Metaphor

Micah 3:12 (#8)

לְבָמֹ֥ות יָֽעַר

“as high places of a forest”

Here Micah is using the possessive form to describe **high places** that are characterized by being overgrown like a **forest**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [as high places overgrown with forest]

See: Possession

Micah - Chapter 4 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Yahweh promises the future glory and restoration of his people.

1. Yahweh establishes his kingdom among the nations (1–5)
2. Yahweh gathers and restores his people (6–8)
3. Yahweh delivers Zion through present suffering (9–13)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

The remnant

Micah speaks about a future hope and a remnant who will return to their homeland. Verses 1–8 are a vision of the future when God will restore Israel to its former glory. These verses will give hope to those about to be removed from their homeland.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Similar passage

Notice that Micah 4:1–3 is very similar to Isaiah 2:2–4. You may want to translate many of these phrases in a similar way.

Daughter Zion

Yahweh is addressing the people of Jerusalem as “daughter Zion” whom he is personifying as a woman —crying out, in labor, then threshing her enemies.

Micah 4:1 (#1)

וְֽהָיָ֗ה הַהַר֙ בֵּ֣ית יְהוָ֔ה נָכֹ֖ון בְּרֹ֣אשׁ הֶהָרִ֑ים וְנִשָּׂ֣א הִגְּבָעֹ֔ות

“the mountain of the house of Yahweh will be established as the head of the mountains. And it will be lifted above the hills”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will make the mountain where his temple stands become more important than all the other hills and mountains]

See: Parallelism

Micah 4:1 (#2)

וְֽהָיָ֗ה הַהַר֙ בֵּ֣ית יְהוָ֔ה נָכֹ֖ון

“the mountain of the house of Yahweh will be established”

The expression **will be established** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who does the action, the context indicates that it is

Yahweh. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will establish the mountain of his house]

See: Active or Passive

Micah 4:1 (#3)

הַהַר בֵּית־יְהוָה

“the mountain of the house of Yahweh”

Here Micah is speaking of the temple as if it were a **house**, since it was the place where Yahweh was present among his people. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the mountain on which the temple of Yahweh stands]

See: Metaphor

Micah 4:1 (#4)

בְּרֹאשׁ הֶהָרִים

“as the head of the mountains”

Micah is speaking of the mountain where his temple stands as if it were **the head of the mountains**. He means that Yahweh will exalt it above all the others so that it becomes the most important one. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [as the most prominent and important of the mountains]

See: Metaphor

Micah 4:1 (#5)

וְנִשָּׂא הוּא

“And it will be lifted”

The expression **will be lifted** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who does the action, the context indicates that it is Yahweh. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh will lift it]

See: Active or Passive

Micah 4:1 (#6)

וְנָהֲרוּ עָלָיו עַמִּים

“and peoples will stream to it”

Micah is speaking of the peoples as if they were water that could **stream** to the mountain. He means that they will come to it together in great numbers, like a river flowing. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and peoples will come to it together in great numbers]

See: Metaphor

Micah 4:2 (#1)

הַר־יְהוָה

“the mountain of Yahweh”

By **the mountain of Yahweh**, the speakers are referring to Mount Zion in Jerusalem, where the temple of Yahweh was located. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Mount Zion]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Micah 4:2 (#2)

בֵּית אֱלֹהֵי יַעֲקֹב

“the house of the God of Jacob”

Here Micah is speaking of the temple as if it were a **house**, since it was the place where Yahweh was present among his people. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the temple of the God of Jacob]

See: Metaphor

Micah 4:2 (#3)

אֱלֹהֵי יַעֲקֹב

“the God of Jacob”

Micah is not using the possessive form **the God of Jacob** to indicate that Jacob possesses or controls God. Rather he is using these words to indicate that God is the one whom Jacob worshiped as modeled in the UST.

See: Possession

Micah 4:2 (#4)

וְיוֹרֵנוּ מִדְּרָכָיו וְנֵלְכָה בְּאֹרְחֹתָיו

“so that he will teach us from his ways, and so that we may walk in his paths”

Micah is speaking of how Yahweh wants people to live as if it were **his ways** and **his paths** that they could walk along. He means that to walk in Yahweh’s paths is to live in the way that he directs. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly.

Alternate translation: [so that he will teach us what he requires, and so that we may live as he directs]

See: Metaphor

Micah 4:2 (#5)

וּדְבַר־יְהוָה מִירוּשָׁלָם

“and the word of Yahweh from Jerusalem”

Micah is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and the word of Yahweh will go out from Jerusalem]

See: Ellipsis

Micah 4:2 (#6)

כִּֽי מִצִּיּוֹן תֵּצֵא תּוֹרָה וּדְבַר־יְהוָה מִירוּשָׁלָם

“For from Zion the law will go out, and the word of Yahweh from Jerusalem”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [For the word of Yahweh will surely go out from Jerusalem]

See: Parallelism

Micah 4:2 (#7)

וּדְבַר־יְהוָה

“and the word of Yahweh”

Micah using the term **the word of Yahweh** to represent what Yahweh said by using words. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and what Yahweh has spoken will go out]

See: Metonymy

Micah 4:3 (#1)

וְשָׁפַט

“And he will judge”

The pronoun **he** refers to Yahweh. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And Yahweh will judge]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 4:3 (#2)

וְכִתְּתוּ

“And they will beat”

The pronoun **they** refers to the many peoples whom Yahweh will judge. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And these many peoples will beat]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 4:3 (#3)

חַרְבֹתֵיהֶם לְאִתִּים וַחֲנִיתֹתֵיהֶם לְמַזְמֵרוֹת לֹא־יִשָּׂא גּוֹי אֶל־גּוֹי חֶרֶב

“their swords into plowshares and their spears into pruning hooks. Nation will not lift up sword against nation”

Here, **sword** and **spears** represent warfare and armed conflict. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [their weapons of war into farming tools. Nation will not make war against nation]

See: Metonymy

Micah 4:4 (#1)

וְיָשְׁבוּ אִישׁ תַּחַת גַּפְנוֹ וְתַחַת תְּאֵנָתוֹ וְאֵין מַחֲרִיד

“And they will sit, each person under his vine and under his fig tree. And there will be no terrorizer”

Here, **under his vine and under his fig tree** represents living peacefully and safely on their own land. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [And they will dwell, each person safely and prosperously on his own land, undisturbed by anyone]

See: Metonymy

Micah 4:4 (#2)

פִּי יְהוָה צְבָאוֹת דִּבֵּר

“the mouth of Yahweh of Armies has spoken”

Micah is using **the mouth of Yahweh** to represent Yahweh himself in the act of speaking. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression from your culture or state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh of Armies himself has spoken]

See: Synecdoche

Micah 4:5 (#1)

כִּֽי כָל־הָֽעַמִּ֗ים יֵלְכ֛וּ אִ֥ישׁ בְּשֵׁ֖ם אֱלֹהָ֑יו

“For all the peoples walk, each one, in the name of his god”

Here, the word **walk** is used to describe a habitual lifestyle. In this context, to **walk ... in the name of his god** describes the people worshiping and obeying their own false gods. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [For all the peoples follow after their own gods] or [For all the peoples serve their own gods]

See: Metaphor

Micah 4:5 (#2)

בְּשֵׁ֖ם אֱלֹהָ֑יו

“in the name of his god”

Here, **name** represents the authority and character of a god. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [under the authority of his god]

See: Metonymy

Micah 4:5 (#3)

וַאֲנַ֖חְנוּ נֵלֵ֥ךְ

“But we, we will walk”

Micah is stating the pronoun **we** separately, even though the verb translated as **we will walk** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize the contrast between what the other nations do and what he and his people will do. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [However, my people and I will walk]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 4:5 (#4)

נֵלֵ֥ךְ בְּשֵׁם־יְהוָ֖ה אֱלֹהֵ֥ינוּ

“we will walk in the name of Yahweh our God”

Again, the word **walk** is used to describe a habitual lifestyle. In contrast to the first phrase in this verse, to **we will walk in the name of Yahweh** describes the Israelites worshiping and obeying the true God, Yahweh. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [we will live in the manner that Yahweh our God wants]

See: Metaphor

Micah 4:5 (#5)

יְהוָ֖ה אֱלֹהֵ֥ינוּ

“Yahweh our God”

Micah is not using this possessive form **our God** to indicate that the Israelites possess or control Yahweh. Rather, they are using these words to indicate that Yahweh is the God whom the Israelites worship, including himself. Alternate translation: [Yahweh, the God whom we worship]

See: Possession

Micah 4:6 (#1)

אֹסְפָ֤ה הַצֹּלֵעָה֙ וְהַנִּדָּחָ֔ה אֶקַּבְּצָ֑ה

“I shall assemble the lame and gather the outcast”

Yahweh is speaking of the people of Israel as if they were a flock of sheep, some of them **lame** and some of them **outcast**, whom he gathers together. He is portraying himself as a shepherd who cares for his scattered and suffering people. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I shall bring together my people who are weak and bring back those who were driven away]

See: Metaphor

Micah 4:6 (#2)

אֹסְפָ֤ה הַצֹּלֵעָה֙ וְהַנִּדָּחָ֔ה אֶקַּבְּצָ֑ה

“I shall assemble the lame and gather the outcast”

Yahweh is using the adjectives **the lame** and **the outcast** as nouns to mean certain kinds of people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate these adjectives with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [I shall assemble those who are lame, and gather those who were outcast]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Micah 4:6 (#3)

הַצֹּלֵעָה֙ וְהַנִּדָּחָ֔ה אֶקַּבְּצָ֑ה

“the lame and gather the outcast”

Yahweh is using the adjectives **the lame** and **the outcast** as nouns to mean certain kinds of people. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If

not, you can translate these adjectives with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [the people who are lame and gather the people who have been cast out]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Micah 4:6 (#4)

וַאֲשֶׁ֥ר הֲרֵעֹ֖תִי

“and those whom I have afflicted”

Yahweh is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and I will gather those whom I have afflicted]

See: Ellipsis

Micah 4:6 (#5)

וַאֲשֶׁ֥ר הֲרֵעֹ֖תִי

“and those whom I have afflicted”

Micah assumes that readers will know that **those whom I have afflicted** would refer to those who survived the previous judgment he predicted Yahweh would bring in the earlier portions. You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [in fact, I will gather all those who survive my discipline]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Micah 4:7 (#1)

לִשְׁאֵרִ֔ית

“into a remnant”

By **remnant**, Yahweh means those few people who he will allow to survive his discipline when he judges the sins of his people. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [into a people who will survive]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Micah 4:7 (#2)

יְהוָ֖ה

“Yahweh”

Yahweh is speaking of himself in the third person as **Yahweh**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person as modeled in the UST.

See: First, Second or Third Person

Micah 4:8 (#1)

מִגְדַּל־עֵ֑דֶר

“watchtower for the flock”

Yahweh is speaking of Jerusalem as if it were a **watchtower** from which a shepherd watches over his flock. He means that the city has the role of protecting and overseeing the people of God. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [protector of my people]

See: Metaphor

Micah 4:8 (#2)

בַּת־צִיּ֔וֹן

“daughter Zion”

Yahweh is using **daughter Zion** as a common expression of the culture to mean “the people of Jerusalem.” He refers to Jerusalem in the same way at the end of this verse. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the people of Jerusalem]

See: Idiom

Micah 4:8 (#3)

עָדֶ֙יךָ֙ תֵּאתֶ֔ה וּבָ֣אָה הַמֶּמְשָׁלָ֔ה הָרִאשֹׁנָ֖ה

“to you it will arrive, and the former dominion will come”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way as in the UST. Another approach would be to connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [your former dominion will come, indeed to you it will arrive]

See: Parallelism

Micah 4:8 (#4)

הַמֶּמְשָׁלָ֔ה הָרִאשֹׁנָ֖ה

“the former dominion”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **dominion**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the right to rule as before]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 4:9 (#1)

לָֽמָּה תָרֵ֥עִי רֵ֖עַ

“why do you shout a shout”

Micah is using the question form to challenge the people of Jerusalem about their loud crying. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [you are shouting loudly!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Micah 4:9 (#2)

תָרֵ֥עִי רֵ֖עַ

“do you shout a shout”

Micah is repeating forms of the verb **shout** in order to intensify his expression of the idea that it conveys. If your language can repeat words for intensification, it would be appropriate to do that here in your translation. If not, your language may have another way of expressing the intensification. Alternate translation: [are you crying out so loudly]

See: Reduplication

Micah 4:9 (#3)

הֲמֶ֣לֶךְ אֵֽין־בָּ֗ךְ אִם־יוֹעֲצֵךְ֙ אָבָ֔ד כִּי־הֶחֱזִיקָ֥ךְ חִיל֖ כַּיּוֹלֵדָֽה

“Is there no king among you, or has your counselor perished, that pain grips you like a woman giving birth”

Micah is using the question form to prompt the people to recognize that they still have a king and a counselor to guide them and thus should not be crying out. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Since you have a king among you, and your counselor has not perished, you do not need to cry out like you are in as much pain as a woman giving birth.]

See: Rhetorical Question

Micah 4:9 (#4)

הֶחֱזִיקָ֥ךְ חִיל֖ כַּיּוֹלֵדָֽה

“pain grips you like a woman giving birth”

The point of this comparison is that just as **a woman giving birth** suffers severe pain, so the people of Jerusalem will experience the same intense anguish. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [pain grips you as severely as the pain of a woman in labor]

See: Simile

Micah 4:9 (#5)

חִיל֖

“pain”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **pain**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [painful spasms]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 4:10 (#1)

חוּלִ֤י וְגֹחֲי֙ בַּת־צִיּ֔וֹן כַּיּוֹלֵדָ֑ה

“Writhe in pain and burst forth, daughter Zion, like a woman giving birth”

The point of this comparison is that just as **a woman giving birth** cries out and writhes in labor, so the people of Jerusalem will agonize in their distress. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [Writhe in pain and cry out, people of Jerusalem, with the same intense anguish that a woman experiences when she is giving birth]

See: Simile

Micah 4:10 (#2)

תִּנָּצֵ֔לִי

“you will be rescued”

The expression **you will be rescued** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. If you need to say who does the action, the context indicates that it is Yahweh. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will be the one who rescues you]

See: Active or Passive

Micah 4:10 (#3)

יְהוָ֖ה

“Yahweh”

Yahweh is speaking of himself in the third person as **Yahweh**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person. Alternate translation: [I, Yahweh]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Micah 4:10 (#4)

מִכַּ֖ף אֹיְבָֽיִךְ

“from the hand of your enemies”

Here, **the hand** of their enemies represents their power and control. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [from the power of your enemies]

See: Metonymy

Micah 4:11 (#1)

וְנֶאֶסְפ֤וּ עָלַ֙יִךְ֙ גּוֹיִ֣ם רַבִּ֔ים

“many nations are assembled against you”

The expression **are assembled** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [many nations have gathered together against you]

See: Active or Passive

Micah 4:11 (#2)

הַֽחֲנֻ֑ף וְתַֽחֲזֶ֖ינָה & עֵינֵֽנוּ

“Let her be defiled and let our eyes gaze”

The people of the other nations are saying what they want to happen to Jerusalem. See the discussion in the introduction to this book about “let” and “may” and follow the decision of your team of how a speakers will express in this context what they want to happen. Alternate translation: [We want her to be defiled and we want our eyes to gaze]

See: Third-Person Imperatives

Micah 4:11 (#3)

וְתַֽחֲזֶ֖ינָה בְּצִיּ֑וֹן עֵינֵֽנוּ

“and let our eyes gaze on Zion”

The nations are using the expression **our eyes gaze** as a common expression of the culture to mean “we will gloat over.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and we want to look with satisfaction on Zion’s downfall]

See: Idiom

Micah 4:12 (#1)

וְהֵ֖מָּה לֹ֣א יָדְע֑וּ

“But they, they do not know”

Yahweh is stating the pronoun **they** separately, even though the verb translated as **they do not know** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize how ignorant the people of the other nations are of his thoughts. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [But of course, they do not know]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 4:12 (#2)

מַחְשְׁבֹ֤ות יְהוָה֙ וְלֹ֣א הֵבִ֔ינוּ עֲצָתֹ֖ו כִּֽי־קִבְּצָ֥ם

“the thoughts of Yahweh and they do not understand his plan, for he has gathered them”

Yahweh is speaking of himself in the third person as **Yahweh**, **his**, and **he**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person here and throughout this verse. Alternate translation: [my thoughts and they do not understand my plan, for I have gather them]

See: First, Second or Third Person

Micah 4:12 (#3)

מַחְשְׁבֹ֤ות יְהוָה֙

“the thoughts of Yahweh”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **thoughts**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [what Yahweh intends]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 4:12 (#4)

קִבְּצָ֥ם כְּעָמְמִ֖יר גֹּ֥רֶן

“he has gathered them like bundles of grain for the threshing floor”

The point of this comparison is that just as **bundles of grain** are gathered to the threshing floor to be crushed, so Yahweh has gathered the nations together

for judgment. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [he has gathered them together so that he can destroy them, just as a farmer gathers bundles of grain to the threshing floor to be crushed]

See: Simile

Micah 4:13 (#1)

קוּמִי וְדָושִׁי בַּת־צִיּוֹן

“Arise and thresh, daughter Zion”

Yahweh is speaking of the people of Jerusalem, or **daughter Zion,** defeating her enemies as if she were an ox that could **thresh** grain. He means that Jerusalem will crush the nations as an ox crushes grain on the threshing floor. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Arise and crush your enemies, people of Jerusalem]

See: Metaphor

Micah 4:13 (#2)

קַרְנֵךְ אָשִׂים בַּרְזֶל וּפַרְסֹתַיִךְ אָשִׂים נְחוּשָׁה

“I will make your horn iron, and I will make your hooves bronze”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way as in the UST. Another approach would be to connect the phrases with a word other than **and** in order to show that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Alternate translation: [I will make your horn iron, indeed I will make your hooves bronze]

See: Parallelism

Micah 4:13 (#3)

קַרְנֵךְ אָשִׂים בַּרְזֶל

“I will make your horn iron”

Yahweh is speaking of the strength he will give Zion as if it were a **horn** made of **iron**. An animal’s horn represents power, and iron represents strength that cannot be broken. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I will make you unbreakably strong]

See: Metaphor

Micah 4:13 (#4)

וּפַרְסֹתַיִךְ אָשִׂים נְחוּשָׁה

“and I will make your hooves bronze”

Yahweh continues to speak of Zion as if it were a powerful threshing ox whose **hooves** he would make of **bronze**. He means that he will make Zion strong enough to trample and crush her enemies. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and I will make you strong enough to trample your enemies]

See: Metaphor

Micah 4:13 (#5)

וְהַחֲרַמְתִּי לַיהוָה בִּצְעָם וְחֵילָם

“and devote to Yahweh their plunder and their wealth”

By **devote**, Yahweh means something that is irrevocably dedicated to him so that it cannot be taken back or used for any other purpose. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and permanently dedicate to Yahweh their plunder and their wealth]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Micah 4:13 (#6)

לַיהוָה

“to Yahweh”

Yahweh is speaking of himself in the third person as **to Yahweh**. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate this in the first person as in the UST.

See: First, Second or Third Person

Micah 4:13 (#7)

בִּצְעָם וְחֵילָם

“their plunder and their wealth”

If your language does not use abstract nouns for the ideas of **plunder** and **wealth**, you could express the same ideas in another way. Alternate translation: [what they have seized and what they own]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 4:13 (#8)

וְחֵילָם לַאֲדֹון כָּל־הָאָרֶץ

“and their wealth to the Lord of all of the earth”

Micah is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and devote their wealth to the Lord of all of the earth]

See: Ellipsis

Micah - Chapter 5 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Yahweh promises a ruler who will shepherd and deliver his people.

1. Yahweh raises up a ruler from Bethlehem (1–6)
2. Yahweh preserves his people among the nations (7–9)
3. Yahweh removes all sources of false security and idolatry (10–15)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Messiah

This chapter contains a prophecy explaining that the Messiah was to be born in Bethlehem. This prophecy is fulfilled by Jesus’s birth and referenced in the New Testament in each of the gospel accounts of that event.

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Change in Personal Pronouns

Extra care must be taken in translating pronouns in this chapter. Sometimes “I” is a reference to the author and other times it is a reference to Yahweh. There is also a noticeable shift where the author stops speaking about the people as “you” and begins speaking about them as “we” or “us.”

Micah 5:1 (#1)

בַּשֵּׁ֥בֶט יַכּ֖וּ עַל־הַלְּחִ֥י

“with the rod they strike on the cheek”

Micah is using **with the rod they strike on the cheek** as a common expression of the culture to mean “they insult and humiliate him.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [they utterly humiliate]

See: Idiom

Micah 5:1 (#2)

בַּת־גְּדוּד

“daughter troop”

Micah is speaking of the surviving remnant of the people of Jerusalem (whom he previously called “daughter Zion”) as if they were a **daughter troop**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly as modeled in the UST.

Micah 5:1 (#3)

מָצ֥וֹר שָׂ֖ם עָלֵֽינוּ

“He has set a siege against us”

The pronoun **He** refers to the enemy who is attacking Jerusalem. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Our enemy has laid siege against us]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 5:1 (#4)

עָלֵֽינוּ

“against us”

By **us**, Micah means himself and the people of Jerusalem to whom he is speaking, so use the inclusive form of that word in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Micah 5:2 (#1)

בֵּ֣ית־לֶ֔חֶם אֶפְרָתָ֖ה

“Bethlehem Ephrathah”

Bethlehem Ephrathah is the name of a town located in a region of Judah (see it referenced in Matthew 2:6). **Ephrathah** distinguished it from another town called “Bethlehem” in the region of Zebulun. It is also called “the city of David” in Luke 2:4, since it was where David, king of Israel, was born.

See: How to Translate Names

Micah 5:2 (#2)

מִמְּךָ֥ לִ֛י יֵצֵ֥א

“from you will come out for me”

The pronoun **me** refers to Yahweh, who is speaking these words through Micah. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [from you will come out for Yahweh]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 5:2 (#3)

וּמוֹצָאֹתָיו מִקֶּדֶם

“and his goings out {are} from aforetime”

Micah is using **his goings out** as a common expression of the culture to mean “his origin.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and his origin is from ancient times]

See: Idiom

Micah 5:2 (#4)

מִימֵי עוֹלָם

“from the days of eternity”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **eternity**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [from the days before time began]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 5:3 (#1)

יִתְּנֵם

“he will give them up”

The pronoun **he** refers to Yahweh, and the pronoun **them** refers to the people of Israel. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Yahweh will give the people of Israel up]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 5:3 (#2)

עַד־עֵת יוֹלֵדָה יָלָדָה

“until the time {when} the bearing {one} gives birth”

This prophecy appears to have two fulfillments. The first fulfillment would be when God brings the people of Israel back to their land. In this case, **the bearing one** would refer to “daughter Zion” 4:10, who stands for the faithful remnant of Israel. She **gives birth** to the restored nation of Israel. The second and greater fulfillment is when the mother of the Messiah gives birth to him who is able to create the new, fully restored people of God, bringing together the remnant of Israel and all of **his brothers** redeemed from the rest of mankind. If possible, translate this in a way that can apply to both fulfillments.

Micah 5:3 (#3)

וְיֶתֶר אֶחָיו

“and the remainder of his brothers”

The pronoun **his** refers to the ruler whom Yahweh has promised. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and the remainder of that ruler’s brothers]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 5:3 (#4)

וְיֶתֶר אֶחָיו

“and the remainder of his brothers”

Micah is speaking of the fellow Israelites of this ruler as if they were his **brothers**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and the remainder of his fellow Israelites]

See: Metaphor

Micah 5:4 (#1)

וְעָמַד

“And he will stand”

The pronoun **he** refers to the ruler that Yahweh promised to raise up from Bethlehem, whom Micah described in the previous verses. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And the ruler will stand]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 5:4 (#2)

וְעָמַד וְרָעָה

“And he will stand and shepherd”

Micah is speaking of this ruler as if he would **shepherd** as one who cares for a flock of sheep. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And he will take his stand and lead and provide for his people]

See: Metaphor

Micah 5:4 (#3)

בִּגְאוֹן שֵׁשֵׁם יְהוָה אֱלֹהָיו

“in the majesty of the name of Yahweh his God”

Here, **the name of Yahweh** represents Yahweh himself and his authority. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [in the majestic authority of Yahweh his God]

See: Metonymy

Micah 5:4 (#4)

וְיָשָׁבוּ

“And they will dwell”

The pronoun **they** refers to the people of Israel, whom this ruler will shepherd. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And the people of Israel will live securely]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 5:5 (#1)

וְהָיָה זֶה שָׁלוֹם

“And this one will be peace”

Micah is speaking of this ruler bringing peace as if he were **peace** itself. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And this one will bring peace to his people]

See: Metaphor

Micah 5:5 (#2)

יָבוֹא

“he comes”

The personal pronouns **he** and **him** throughout this verse refer to Assyria, which stands for the Assyrian army. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Assyria—when the Assyrian army comes into our land]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 5:5 (#3)

בְּאַרְצֵנוּ וְכִי יִדְרֹךְ בְּאַרְמְנוֹתֵינוּ

“into our land, and when he treads on our citadels”

By **our** and **we**, Micah means himself and the people of Israel to whom he is speaking, so use the inclusive form of that word in your translation if your language marks that distinction.

See: Exclusive and Inclusive ‘We’

Micah 5:5 (#4)

וַהֲקֵמְנוּ עָלָיו

“then we will raise up against him”

Micah is speaking of the people choosing leaders as if they would **raise up** these leaders to a high place. If it would be clearer in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [then we will choose to fight against them]

See: Metaphor

Micah 5:5 (#5)

שִׁבְעָה רֹעִים וּשְׁמֹנָה נְסִיכֵי אָדָם

“seven shepherds and eight princes of man”

Micah is using **seven shepherds** and **eight princes of man** as a common expression of the culture to mean “as many leaders as will be needed.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [as many leaders as will be needed]

See: Idiom

Micah 5:6 (#1)

וְרָעוּ

“And they will shepherd”

The pronoun **they** refers to the leaders mentioned in the previous verse who will fight against Assyria. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And these leaders will shepherd]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 5:6 (#2)

וְרָעוּ אֶת־אֶרֶץ אַשּׁוּר בַּחֶרֶב

“And they will shepherd the land of Assyria with the sword”

Micah is speaking of these leaders ruling with military power as if they would **shepherd** them like a herd of sheep but in this context of the Assyrians, it would be **with a sword**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And they will rule the land of Assyria with military power]

See: Metaphor

Micah 5:6 (#3)

וְאֶת־אֶ֣רֶץ נִמְרֹ֔ד בִּפְתָחֶ֖יהָ

“and the land of Nimrod in its entrances”

Micah is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and they will shepherd the land of Nimrod in its entrances]

See: Ellipsis

Micah 5:6 (#4)

וְאֶת־אֶ֣רֶץ נִמְרֹ֔ד

“and the land of Nimrod”

Here, **the land of Nimrod** represents the territory that the ancient ruler Nimrod founded, that is, Assyria. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [which is the land that Nimrod founded,]

See: How to Translate Names

Micah 5:6 (#5)

בִּפְתָחֶ֖יהָ

“in its entrances”

The phrase **in its entrances** is a translation of the standard written Hebrew text. This reading, however, does not seem to make sense. Scholars have proposed that the original reading was a very similar word meaning “drawn sword,” which is represented in some ancient translations. You may want to follow this reading, or you may want to follow the major translation in your area. Alternate translation: [with a drawn sword]

See: Alternative Readings

Micah 5:6 (#6)

וְהִצִּ֣ילָ֔ מֵאַשּׁ֑וּר

“And he will deliver {us} from Assyria”

The pronoun **he** refers to the ruler whom Yahweh has promised. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [And the promised ruler will rescue us from Assyria]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 5:7 (#1)

שְׁאֵרִ֣ית יַעֲקֹ֔ב

“the remnant of Jacob”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **remnant**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [those of Jacob who remain]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 5:7 (#2)

שְׁאֵרִ֣ית יַעֲקֹ֔ב

“the remnant of Jacob”

Here, **Jacob** represents the descendants of Jacob, that is, the people of Israel. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [the remnant of the people of Israel]

See: Metonymy

Micah 5:7 (#3)

כְּטַלָּ֤ מֵאֵת֙ יְהוָ֔ה כִּרְבִיבִ֖ים עֲלֵי־עֵ֑שֶׂב

“like dew from Yahweh, like showers on the grass”

The point of this comparison is that just as **dew** and **showers** come from Yahweh and refresh the grass, so the survivors of Israel will be a blessing to the many peoples among whom they live. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [a blessing to them, like refreshing dew that comes from Yahweh, like showers on the grass]

See: Simile

Micah 5:7 (#4)

אֲשֶׁ֤ר לֹא־יְקַוֶּה֙ לְאִ֔ישׁ

“that does not wait for a man”

The pronoun **that** refers to the **dew** and the **showers**, which come from Yahweh rather than from any human effort. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [moisture that does not wait for a man]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 5:7 (#5)

אֲשֶׁ֤ר לֹא־יְקַוֶּה֙ לְאִ֔ישׁ וְלֹ֥א יְיַחֵ֖ל לִבְנֵ֥י אָדָֽם

“that does not wait for a man and does not hope for the sons of man”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeat-

ing the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [that does depend completely on Yahweh and not on people at all]

See: Parallelism

Micah 5:7 (#6)

לֹא־יְקַוֶּה לְאִישׁ וְלֹא יְיַחֵל לִבְנֵי אָדָם

“does not wait for a man and does not hope for the sons of man”

Here, **a man** and **the sons of man** represent people in general, not specific individuals. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use expressions that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [does not wait for anyone and does not hope for any human being]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Micah 5:8 (#1)

שְׁאֵרִית יַעֲקֹב

“the remnant of Jacob”

See how you translated the abstract noun **remnant** in 5:7.

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 5:8 (#2)

שְׁאֵרִית יַעֲקֹב

“the remnant of Jacob”

See how you translated **Jacob** in 5:7.

See: Metonymy

Micah 5:8 (#3)

כְּאַרְיֵה בְּבַהֲמוֹת יַעַר כְּכְפִיר בְּעֶדְרֵי צֹאן

“like a lion among the animals of the forest, like a young lion among the flocks of sheep”

The point of this comparison is that just as **a lion** is stronger than the other animals and **a young lion** can attack a flock of sheep without being stopped, so the survivors of Israel will be stronger than the peoples among whom they live. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [as strong as a lion among the animals of the forest, as unstoppable as a young lion among the flocks of sheep]

See: Simile

Micah 5:8 (#4)

וְרָמַס וְטָרַף

“both tramples and tears”

The terms **tramples** and **tears** mean similar things. Micah is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [tears to pieces]

See: Doublet

Micah 5:9 (#1)

תָּרֹם יָדְךָ עַל־צָרֶיךָ וְכָל־אוֹיְבֶיךָ יִכָּרֵתוּ

“May your hand rise over your adversaries, and may all of your enemies be cut off”

Some ancient manuscripts read according to the ULT. Other ancient manuscripts read “Your hand will rise over your adversaries, and all of your enemies will be cut off.” In that case, “your” could refer either to Yahweh or to Jacob, who represents his descendants. If a translation of the Bible exists in your region, you may wish to use the reading that it uses. If a translation of the Bible does not exist in your region, you may wish to use the reading of the ULT.

See: Textual Variants

Micah 5:9 (#2)

תָּרֹם יָדְךָ עַל־צָרֶיךָ וְכָל־אוֹיְבֶיךָ יִכָּרֵתוּ

“May your hand rise over your adversaries, and may all of your enemies be cut off”

Micah is saying what he wants Yahweh to do. See the discussion in the introduction to this book about “let” and “may” and follow the decision of your team of how a speaker will express in this context what he wants someone to do. Alternate translation: [Yahweh, I desire that your hand rise over your adversaries and that all your enemies be destroyed]

See: Third-Person Imperatives

Micah 5:9 (#3)

תָּרֹם יָדְךָ עַל־צָרֶיךָ

“May your hand rise over your adversaries”

Here, **your hand** represents Yahweh’s power. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [May you triumph by your power over your adversaries]

See: Metonymy

Micah 5:9 (#4)

וְכָל־אֹיְבֶיךָ יִכָּרֵתוּ

“and may all of your enemies be cut off”

The expression **be cut off** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and may you cut off all of your enemies]

See: Active or Passive

Micah 5:9 (#5)

וְכָל־אֹיְבֶיךָ יִכָּרֵתוּ

“and may all of your enemies be cut off”

Micah is using **be cut off** as a common expression of the culture to mean “be destroyed.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and may all of your enemies be destroyed]

See: Idiom

Micah 5:10 (#1)

וְהָיָה בַיּוֹם־הַהוּא

“And it will be on that day”

Micah is using **on that day** as a common expression of the culture to mean “at that time.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And it will be when that happens]

See: Connecting Words and Phrases

Micah 5:10 (#2)

נְאֻם־יְהוָֹה

“the declaration of Yahweh”

Micah is using **the declaration of Yahweh** to indicate that what follows is a direct quotation from Yahweh. In your translation, use a natural way of indicating direct quotations in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Micah 5:10 (#3)

סוּסֶיךָ מִקִּרְבֶּךָ וְהַאֲבַדְתִּי מַרְכְּבֹתֶיךָ

“your horses from your midst, and I will destroy your chariots”

Here, **horses** and **chariots** represent “military power.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [your military power and I will destroy your means of waging war]

See: Metonymy

Micah 5:10 (#4)

סוּסֶיךָ מִקִּרְבֶּךָ

“your horses from your midst”

The pronoun **your** refers to the people of Israel, whom Yahweh is addressing here. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [your horses from your midst, people of Israel]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 5:11 (#1)

וְהִכְרַתִּי

“And I will cut off”

Yahweh is using **cut off** as a common expression of the culture to mean “destroy.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And I will destroy]

See: Idiom

Micah 5:12 (#1)

כְּשָׁפִים מִיָּדֶךָ

“sorceries from your hand”

Here, **your hand** represents “what you do.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [sorceries from what you do]

See: Metonymy

Micah 5:12 (#2)

וְהִכְרַתִּי כְשָׁפִים מִיָּדֶךָ

“And I will cut off sorceries from your hand”

Yahweh is using **cut off** to mean “destroy” and **sorceries from your hand** to represent their power to

practice witchcraft. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I will destroy your power to practice sorcery]

See: Metonymy

Micah 5:12 (#3)

כְּשָׁפִֽים

“sorceries”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **sorceries**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the practice of magic]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 5:12 (#4)

לֹ֥א יִהְיוּ־לָֽךְ

“will not be to you”

Yahweh is using **be to you** as a common expression of the culture to mean “you will no longer have.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you will no longer have]

See: Idiom

Micah 5:13 (#1)

וְהִכְרַתְתִּ֥י

“And I will cut off”

Yahweh is using **cut off** as a common expression of the culture to mean “destroy completely” or “get rid of.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And I will wipe out] or [And I will get rid of]

See: Idiom

Micah 5:13 (#2)

וְלֹא־תִשְׁתַּחֲוֶ֖ה עֹ֑וד

“and you will & longer”

To **bow down** was a symbolic action by which people showed reverence and submission. In this context, it was an action by which a person showed worship or submission to an idol. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [and you will not submit yourselves]

See: Symbolic Action

Micah 5:13 (#3)

לְמַעֲשֵׂ֥ה יָדֶֽיךָ

“to the work of your hands”

Yahweh is using **the work of your hands** to represent the things that the people make and do, particularly idols and acts of worship directed toward them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [to the idols you make and worship]

See: Metonymy

Micah 5:14 (#1)

וְנָתַשְׁתִּ֥י אֲשֵׁירֶ֖יךָ

“And I will uproot your Asherah s”

Yahweh is speaking of the poles that the people use to worship the goddess Asherah as if they were plants that he would **uproot**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [And I will tear out your Asherah poles]

See: Metaphor

Micah 5:15 (#1)

בְּאַ֖ף

“in nose”

Yahweh is using **in nose** as a common expression of the culture to mean “in anger.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [in anger]

See: Idiom

Micah 5:15 (#2)

בְּאַ֖ף וּבְחֵמָ֑ה

“in nose and in wrath”

The terms **nose** and **wrath** mean similar things. Yahweh is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express

the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [in furious anger]

See: Doublet

Micah 5:15 (#3)

וּבְחֵמָ֥ה נָקָ֖ם

“and in wrath vengeance”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **vengeance**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and in wrath I will avenge myself]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 5:15 (#4)

לֹ֥א שָׁמֵֽעוּ

“have not listened”

Yahweh assumes that readers will know that **listened** as it is used here, includes the meaning of “obeyed.” You could say that explicitly if that would be helpful to your readers as modeled in the UST.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Micah - Chapter 6 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

This chapter is written as a court case or lawsuit by Yahweh against His people. Yahweh calls his people to repentance and faithful living.

1. Yahweh brings his case against Israel (1–5)
2. Yahweh desires justice, mercy, and humble obedience (6–8)
3. Yahweh announces judgment for Israel’s sin (9–16)

Translation Issues in This Chapter

Names in lawsuit

Moses, Aaron and Miriam are mentioned as witnesses for Yahweh and against Israel.

Micah 6:1 (#1)

קוּם֙ רִ֣יב אֶת־הֶהָרִ֔ים וְתִשְׁמַ֖עְנָה הַגְּבָעֹ֑ות קוֹלֶֽךָ׃

“Arise, contend before the mountains, and let the hills hear your voice”

If it would be clearer in your language, you could translate this so that there is not a quotation within a quotation. Alternate translation: [Yahweh commands me to arise and contend before the mountains, and to let the hills hear my voice]

See: Quotes within Quotes

Micah 6:1 (#2)

וְתִשְׁמַ֖עְנָה הַגְּבָעֹ֑ות

“and let the hills hear”

Yahweh is saying what he wants the hills to do. See the discussion in the introduction to this book about “let” and “may” and follow the decision of your team of how a speaker will express in this context what he wants to happen. Alternate translation: [the hills should be able to hear]

See: Third-Person Imperatives

Micah 6:1 (#3)

קוֹלֶֽךָ׃

“your voice”

The pronoun **your** refers to Micah, the prophet whom Yahweh is commanding to speak. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [your voice, Micah]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 6:2 (#1)

שִׁמְעוּ֙ הָרִ֣ים אֶת־רִ֔יב יְהוָ֖ה וְהָאֵתָנִ֑ים מֹוסְדֵ֖י אָֽרֶץ

“Hear the dispute of Yahweh, mountains, and permanent foundations of the earth”

Micah is speaking to the **mountains** and the **foundations of the earth**, which he knows cannot hear him. He is doing this to communicate to the people listening to him that he feels very strongly about everything in all creation hearing the case that Yahweh is bringing against them. If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate these words as if he were speaking directly to the people about the mountains and the foundations of the earth. Alternate translation: [Let all creation hear the dispute of Yahweh]

See: Apostrophe

Micah 6:2 (#2)

אֶת־רִ֔יב יְהוָ֖ה

“the dispute of Yahweh”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **dispute**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [Yahweh as he disputes]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 6:2 (#3)

עִם־עַמּוֹ

“with his people”

The pronoun **his** refers to Yahweh, and the phrase **his people** refers to the Israelites. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [with the Israelites, his people]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 6:2 (#4)

כִּֽי־רִ֤יב לַֽיהוָה֙ עִם־עַמּ֔וֹ וְעִם־יִשְׂרָאֵ֖ל יִתְוַכָּֽח

“for a dispute{is} to Yahweh with his people, and with Israel he will argue”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [for Yahweh has a dispute that he is bringing against his people, Israel]

See: Parallelism

Micah 6:2 (#5)

רִ֤יב לַֽיהוָה֙ עִם־עַמּ֔וֹ

“a dispute{is} to Yahweh with his people”

Micah is using **a dispute is to Yahweh** as a common expression of the culture to mean “Yahweh has a dispute.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Yahweh has a dispute with his people]

See: Idiom

Micah 6:3 (#1)

עַמִּ֣י מֶה־עָשִׂ֔יתִי לְךָ֖

“My people, what have I done to you”

This verse begins a direct quotation from Yahweh that continues through verse 5. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could mark that this is a direct quote of Yahweh as modeled in the UST.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Micah 6:3 (#2)

מֶה־עָשִׂ֔יתִי לְךָ֖ וּמָ֣ה הֶלְאֵתִ֑יךָ

“what have I done to you, and how have I wearied you”

Yahweh is using the question form to assert that he has done nothing to harm his people. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [I have done nothing to harm you or to burden you!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Micah 6:3 (#3)

עֲנֵ֖ה בִּֽי

“Testify against me”

By **Testify against me**, Yahweh is using the language of a court and saying that if they actually have anything to accuse him of, they should testify. The implication from the previous questions is that they have nothing to accuse him of. You could indicate this explicitly in your translation if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [Only if I have done anything wrong can you testify against me]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Micah 6:4 (#1)

וּמִבֵּ֣ית עֲבָדִ֔ים

“and from the house of slaves”

Yahweh is speaking of Egypt as if it had been a **house** where people kept **slaves.** Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and from where you were held as slaves]

See: Metaphor

Micah 6:4 (#2)

לְפָנֶ֑יךָ

“to your face”

Here, **to your face** represents “before you” or “ahead of you.” If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [ahead of you]

See: Metonymy

Micah 6:5 (#1)

זְכָר & מַה־יָּעַ֤ץ בָּלָק֙ מֶ֣לֶךְ מוֹאָ֔ב וּמָֽה־עָנָ֥ה אֹתוֹ֙ בִּלְעָ֔ם בֶּן־בְּעֹ֑ור

“remember what Balak, king of Moab, counseled, and what Balaam, son of Beor, answered him”

Yahweh assumes that readers will know that he is referring to the events describe in Numbers 22–24. The phrase **what Balak, king of Moab, counseled** refers to his plot to destroy Israel by hiring Balaam to curse them and **what Balaam, son of Beor, answered him** refers to the fact that Balaam told the king he could only bless the people rather than curse them. You could include this information in a footnote if that would be helpful to your readers.

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Micah 6:5 (#2)

מִן־הַשִּׁטִּים עַד־הַגִּלְגָּל

“from Shittim to Gilgal”

The implication is that Yahweh wants his people to remember what happened to their ancestors when they were able to miraculously cross the Jordan River (see Joshua 3 and 4). **Shittim** was the location of their last camp east of the Jordan River, and **Gilgal**, was where first camped in the land that he had promised them. You could include this information if that would be helpful to your readers. Alternate translation: [and remember what I did for your ancestors when they crossed the Jordan River]

See: Assumed Knowledge and Implicit Information

Micah 6:5 (#3)

צִדְקֹת יְהוָה

“the righteousnesses of Yahweh”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **righteousnesses**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [how Yahweh acted righteously toward you]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 6:6 (#1)

בַּמֶּה אֲקַדֵּם יְהוָה

“With what shall I come before Yahweh”

This verse begins a shift from Yahweh’s words to the direct quotation spoken by a worshiper who represents the people. In your translation, use a natural way of indicating this shift in speaker.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Micah 6:6 (#2)

אִכָּפֵף לֵאלֹהֵי

“bow down to the God of”

To **bow down** was a symbolic action by which people showed reverence and worship. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could explain the significance of this action in the text of your translation or in a footnote. Alternate translation: [worship the God of]

See: Symbolic Action

Micah 6:6 (#3)

אִכָּפֵף

“bow down”

The speaker is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [With what shall I bow down]

See: Ellipsis

Micah 6:6 (#4)

לֵאלֹהֵי מָרוֹם

“to the God of the height”

The speaker is using the possessive form to describe a **God** that is characterized by **the height**, that is, by his exalted position. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [to the exalted God]

See: Possession

Micah 6:6 (#5)

בַּעֲגָלִים בְּנֵי שָׁנָה

“with calves, sons of a year”

The speaker is using **calves, sons of a year** as a common expression of the culture to mean “calves that are one year old.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [with calves that are one year old]

See: Idiom

Micah 6:7 (#1)

בְּאַלְפֵי אֵילִים בְּרִבְבוֹת נַחֲלֵי־שָׁמֶן

“with thousands of rams, with ten thousands of rivers of oil”

The speaker says **thousands of rams, with ten thousands of rivers of oil** as an extreme statement for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [an enormous number of rams, with an unimaginable amount of oil]

See: Hyperbole

Micah 6:7 (#2)

פִּשְׁעִ֑י

“for} my transgression”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **transgression**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [for the ways I have rebelled]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 6:7 (#3)

פְּרִ֥י בִטְנִ֖י

“the fruit of my belly”

Here the speaker is speaking of a child who came from his own body as if it were **the fruit of my belly**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [my own child that I fathered]

See: Metaphor

Micah 6:8 (#1)

הִגִּ֣יד לְךָ֔ אָדָ֖ם

“He has told you, man”

In this verse the speaker changes, as Micah answers the questions that the previous speaker has asked. In your translation, use a natural way of indicating a change of speaker in your language.

See: Quotations and Quote Margins

Micah 6:8 (#2)

הִגִּ֣יד

“He has told”

The pronoun **He** refers to Yahweh. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Yahweh has told]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 6:8 (#3)

אָדָ֖ם

“man”

Micah is not referring to a specific **man**. He means people in general. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [human being]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Micah 6:8 (#4)

מִשְׁפָּ֔ט

“justice”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **justice**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [what is right and fair]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 6:8 (#5)

וְאַהֲבַ֥ת חֶ֖סֶד

“and the love of covenant faithfulness”

Micah is using the possessive form to describe a **love** that is characterized as **covenant faithfulness**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and love faithfully]

See: Possession

Micah 6:8 (#6)

וְאַהֲבַ֥ת חֶ֖סֶד

“and the love of covenant faithfulness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **covenant faithfulness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and faithfully loving others]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 6:8 (#7)

וְהַצְנֵ֥עַ לֶ֛כֶת עִם־אֱלֹהֶ֖יךָ

“and to be humble to walk with your God”

Here Micah is speaking of how one lives as if it were **to walk** down a path and by **with your God**, he means that one should live one’s whole life in fellowship with

God. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and to be humble as you live your whole life in fellowship with your God]

See: Metaphor

Micah 6:8 (#8)

אֱלֹהֶיךָ

“your God”

Micah is using the possessive form **your God** to mean that Yahweh is the God whom the people worship, not that they possess or control him. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Yahweh, the God whom you worship]

See: Possession

Micah 6:9 (#1)

קוֹל יְהוָה & יִקְרָא

“The voice of Yahweh calls”

The phrase **The voice of Yahweh** represents the message that Yahweh speaks. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [The message that Yahweh speaks]

See: Metonymy

Micah 6:9 (#2)

לָעִיר

“to the city”

Here, **the city** represents the people who live in the city of Jerusalem. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [to the people of the city]

See: Metonymy

Micah 6:9 (#3)

וְתוּשִׁיָּה יִרְאֶה שְׁמֶךָ

“and sound wisdom fears your name”

Micah has been speaking to the people about Yahweh, but here he briefly turns aside and addresses Yahweh directly. He does this in order to express more powerfully his own reverence for Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could introduce this more clearly and put the rest of this address in quote marks. Alternate translation: [and I say to Yahweh, “Sound wisdom fears your name”]

See: Aside

Micah 6:9 (#4)

וְתוּשִׁיָּה

“and sound wisdom”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **sound wisdom**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and whoever is truly wise]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 6:9 (#5)

שְׁמֶךָ

“your name”

Here, **your name** represents Yahweh himself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [you yourself]

See: Metonymy

Micah 6:9 (#6)

וּמִי יְעָדָהּ

“and whoever he appointed”

The pronoun **he** refers to Yahweh. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and whoever Yahweh appointed]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 6:9 (#7)

וּמִי יְעָדָהּ

“and whoever he appointed”

The phrase **and whoever he appointed** is a translation of the standard written Hebrew text as we have it today. Scholars have proposed, however, that the first word of the next verse should actually belong to this verse, and that the letters of the words have been divided incorrectly in the present text. By adding the first word of verse 10 to this phrase, changing two letters in it, and dividing the words differently, the meaning would be as in this alternate translation. You may want to follow the ULT or you may want to follow the major translation in your area. Alternate translation: [and the assembly of the city]

See: Alternative Readings

Micah 6:10 (#1)

עֹ֣וד הַאֵ֗שׁ בֵּ֚בֵית רָשָׁ֔ע אֹצְרֹ֖ות רֶ֣שַׁע וְאֵיפַ֥ת רָזֹ֖ון זְעוּמָֽה

“Are there still {in} the house of the wicked treasuries of wickedness, and the ephah of leanness {that is} cursed”

Yahweh is using the question form to accuse the people of the city of cheating others in their business dealings. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [There are still in the house of the wicked treasuries of wickedness, and the ephah of leanness that is cursed!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Micah 6:10 (#2)

עֹ֣וד הַאֵ֗שׁ

“Are there still”

The phrase **Are there still** is a translation of the standard written Hebrew text as we have it today. The wording in the text, however, is very unusual, and scholars have proposed that the first word should be read with the previous verse and that a letter has dropped off of the second word. Reading the text in this way results in the following alternate translation. You may want to follow the ULT or you may want to follow the major translation in your area. Alternate translation: [Can I forget]

See: Alternative Readings

Micah 6:10 (#3)

רָשָׁ֔ע

“the wicked”

Yahweh is using the adjective **wicked** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [the person who is wicked]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Micah 6:10 (#4)

רֶ֣שַׁע

“wickedness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **wickedness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [things gained wickedly]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 6:10 (#5)

וְאֵיפַ֥ת רָזֹ֖ון

“and the ephah of leanness”

This **ephah** was equivalent to 22 liters or nearly two thirds of a bushel. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could express this in terms of modern measurements, either in the text or in a footnote.

See: Biblical Volume

Micah 6:10 (#6)

וְאֵיפַ֥ת רָזֹ֖ון

“and the ephah of leanness”

Yahweh is using the possessive form to describe an **ephah** that is characterized by **leanness**, that is, a measure that holds less than it should. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [and the undersized ephah]

See: Possession

Micah 6:10 (#7)

זְעוּמָֽה

“that is} cursed”

The expression **is cursed** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [that I, Yahweh, have cursed]

See: Active or Passive

Micah 6:11 (#1)

הַאֶזְכֶּ֖ה בְּמֹאזְנֵ֣י רֶ֑שַׁע וּבְכִיסֵ֖י אַבְנֵ֥י מִרְמָֽה

“Would I be innocent with scales of wickedness, and with a bag of stones of deceit”

Yahweh is using the question form to declare that no one who uses dishonest weights and measures can be innocent. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [I certainly would not be innocent if I used scales of wickedness and a bag of stones of deceit!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Micah 6:11 (#2)

הַאֶזְכֶּה

“Would I be innocent”

The phrase **Would I be innocent** is a translation of the standard written Hebrew text as we have it today. It would also be possible to read the word as “Would I acquit.” You may want to follow the ULT or you may want to follow the major translation in your area. Alternate translation: [Would I acquit someone]

See: Alternative Readings

Micah 6:11 (#3)

בְּמֹאזְנֵי רֶשַׁע

“with scales of wickedness”

Yahweh is using the possessive form to describe **scales** that are used for **wickedness** or cheating people. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [with unjust scales]

See: Possession

Micah 6:11 (#4)

וַאֲבָנֵי מִרְמָה

“stones of deceit”

Yahweh is using the possessive form to describe **stones**, which were used to weigh things they were selling, that are characterized by **deceit** because they were the wrong weight. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [deceitful stones]

See: Possession

Micah 6:12 (#1)

אֲשֶׁר עֲשִׁירֶיהָ

“which her rich”

The words **which** and **her** refer to the city that Yahweh mentioned in verse 9. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [—the city whose rich]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 6:12 (#2)

עֲשִׁירֶיהָ

“her rich”

Yahweh is using the adjective **rich** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [her rich people]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Micah 6:12 (#3)

חָמָס

“violence”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **violence**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [violent acts]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 6:12 (#4)

וְיֹשְׁבֶיהָ דִּבְּרוּ־שָׁקֶר וּלְשׁוֹנָם רְמִיָּה בְּפִיהֶם

“and her inhabitants speak falsehood, and their tongue {is} deceit in their mouth”

These two clauses mean basically the same thing. The second emphasizes the meaning of the first by repeating the same idea with different words. You could use the approach which is modeled in the UST of connecting the phrases with a word other than “and” that shows that the second phrase is repeating the first one, not saying something additional. Another approach would be to combine them and express the emphasis in another way. Alternate translation: [and all her inhabitants speak deceitfully]

See: Parallelism

Micah 6:12 (#5)

שָׁקֶר

“falsehood”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **falsehood**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [her inhabitants speak falsely]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 6:12 (#6)

וּלְשׁוֹנָם רְמִיָּה בְּפִיהֶם

“and their tongue {is} deceit in their mouth”

Here, **tongue** represents speech. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and what they say is deceitful]

See: Metonymy

Micah 6:13 (#1)

וְגַם־אֲנִי֙ הֶחֱלֵ֣יתִי

“And even I, I will make sick”

Yahweh is stating the pronoun **I** separately, even though the verb translated as **I will make** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize that Yahweh himself is the one who will act. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [And even I, myself will make sick]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 6:13 (#2)

הֶחֱלֵ֣יתִי הַכּוֹתֶ֔ךָ

“I will make sick the striking of you”

Yahweh is using **make sick the striking of you** as a common expression of the culture to mean that he will administer an incurable injury on them. If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I will strike you with an incurable wound]

See: Idiom

Micah 6:13 (#3)

הַכּוֹתֶ֔ךָ

“the striking of you”

The pronouns **you** and **your** from here to the end of the chapter refer to the people of the city of Jerusalem whom Yahweh is now addressing directly after speaking about them in the previous verses. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the striking of you, inhabitants of Jerusalem]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 6:14 (#1)

אַתָּ֥ה תֹאכַ֖ל

“You, you will eat”

Yahweh is stating the pronoun **you** separately, even though the verb translated as **you will eat** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize the contrast between the heavenly Judge and the sentence they will suffer. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [For your part, you will eat]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 6:14 (#2)

וְיֶשְׁחֲךָ֖ בְּקִרְבֶּֽךָ

“for dysentery {will be} inside you”

The word **dysentery** refers to a kind of disease of the bowels that empties the body of the food it takes in. If your readers would not be familiar with what dysentery is, you could use the name of a similar sickness that your readers would recognize, or you could use a more general term. Alternate translation: [because your stomach will be empty]

See: Translate Unknowns

Micah 6:14 (#3)

וְתַסֵּ֖גֹ וְלֹ֣א תַפְלִ֑יט וַאֲשֶׁ֥ר תְּפַלֶּ֖ט

“And you will bring to safety but not deliver, and what you do deliver”

The word translated as **bring to safety** could also be the word for “reach.” This leads some scholars to interpret these sentences in the context of birthing rather than warfare. You may want to follow the major translation in your area. Alternate translation: [And you will reach birth, but not deliver the baby]

See: Alternative Readings

Micah 6:14 (#4)

לַחֶ֖רֶב אֶתֵּֽן

“I will give to the sword”

Here, **the sword** represents warfare and being killed in battle. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [I will hand over to be killed in war]

See: Metonymy

Micah 6:15 (#1)

אַתָּ֥ה תִזְרַ֖ע וְלֹ֣א תִקְצָ֑וֹר אַתָּ֥ה תִדְרֹ֖ךְ

“You, you will sow but not reap; you, you will tread”

Yahweh is stating the pronoun **you** separately, even though the verbs translated as **you will sow** and **you will tread** already include this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize how the people will suffer. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [You people of the city will certainly sow, but not reap, and you will certainly tread]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 6:15 (#2)

וְתִירַ֖וֹשׁ וְלֹ֣א תִשְׁתֶּה־יָּ֑יִן

“and—new wine but not drink wine”

Yahweh is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and you will tread new wine grapes but not drink wine]

See: Ellipsis

Micah 6:16 (#1)

וַיִּשְׁתַּמְּר֖וּ חֻקּ֣וֹת עָמְרִ֑י

“For the statutes of Omri are kept”

The expression **are kept** is a passive verbal form. If it would be unnatural to use that form, you could express the idea in active form or in another way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [For the people keep the statutes of Omri]

See: Active or Passive

Micah 6:16 (#2)

חֻקּ֣וֹת עָמְרִ֑י

“the statutes of Omri”

Yahweh is using this possessive form to mean the statutes that Omri established. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the statutes that Omri established]

See: Possession

Micah 6:16 (#3)

וְכֹ֖ל מַעֲשֵׂ֣ה בֵית־אַחְאָ֑ב

“and all of the deeds of the house of Ahab”

Yahweh is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and all of the deeds of the house of Ahab are kept]

See: Ellipsis

Micah 6:16 (#4)

בֵּית־אַחְאָ֔ב

“the house of Ahab”

Here, **house** means all the people descended from a particular person. It envisions them as if they were one household living together. So **the house of Ahab** figuratively means all the people descended from that evil king as modeled in the UST.

See: Metaphor

Micah 6:16 (#5)

בֵּית־אַחְאָ֔ב

“the house of Ahab”

Here Yahweh is speaking as if the descendants of Ahab were a **house**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [the descendants of Ahab]

See: Metaphor

Micah 6:16 (#6)

וַתֵּלְכ֖וּ בְּמֹעֲצוֹתָ֑ם

“and you have walked in their counsels”

Here Yahweh is speaking as if living according to the advice of Omri and Ahab were to have **walked in their counsels**. He is referring to the corrupt policies, economic injustice, and foreign idol worship (like Baal worship) institutionalized by Omri and his son, Ahab (see 1 Kings 16). Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you have followed their advice]

See: Metaphor

Micah 6:16 (#7)

לְשַׁמָּ֔ה

“a desolation”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **a desolation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [desolate]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 6:16 (#8)

וְיֹשְׁבֶ֖יהָ

“and her inhabitants”

The pronoun **her** refers to the city that Yahweh mentioned in verse 9. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and the inhabitants of that city]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 6:16 (#9)

לִשְׁרֵקָ֑ה

“a hissing”

Here, **a hissing** represents the scorn that people will express toward those who live in the city. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [and her inhabitants an object of scorn]

See: Metonymy

Micah - Chapter 7 Introduction

Structure and Formatting

Yahweh hears the repentant and faithfully restores his people

1. Micah laments Israel’s corruption (1–6)
2. Micah waits in hope for Yahweh’s salvation (7–13)
3. Yahweh shows mercy and remains faithful to his covenant (14–20)

Religious and Cultural Concepts in This Chapter

Last days

This chapter looks forward to the hope of the coming savior for the faithful remnant. This is the future restoration of Israel when true peace will come.

Prophet

The prophet was able to speak to God on behalf of the people. Often in this chapter, the prophet speaks in Israel’s place and offers repentance to Yahweh.

Micah 7:1 (#1)

אַ֣לְלַי לִ֔י

“Woe to me”

Micah is using a phrase that expresses a strong feeling of distress. There may be an equivalent word or phrase in your language that you can use in your translation to convey this feeling. Alternate translation: [How sorrowful I feel]

See: Exclamations

Micah 7:1 (#2)

כְּאָסְפֵ֤י־קַ֙יִץ֙ כְּעֹלְלֹ֣ת בָּצִ֔יר

“like the gatherings of summer fruit, like the gleanings of the grape harvest”

The point of this comparison is that just as **the gatherings of summer fruit** and **the gleanings of the grape harvest** are what remains after everything worth having has already been taken, so is the land in which Micah is searching for a faithful person. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [like one searching where the summer fruit has already been gathered, like one searching where the grapes have already been harvested]

See: Simile

Micah 7:1 (#3)

כְּאָסְפֵ֤י־קַ֙יִץ֙

“like the gatherings of summer fruit”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **gatherings**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [trying to gather summer fruit after others have already picked all of it]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 7:1 (#4)

כְּעֹלְלֹ֣ת בָּצִ֔יר

“like the gleanings of the grape harvest”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **gleanings**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [like what is left over after others have harvested the grapes]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 7:1 (#5)

נַפְשִׁ֖י

“my soul desires”

Here, **my soul** represents Micah himself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent

expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [I desire]

See: Metonymy

Micah 7:2 (#1)

כֻּלָּם֙ לְדָמִ֣ים יֶאֱרֹֽבוּ

“All of them lie in wait for bloodshed”

Micah says **All of them lie in wait for bloodshed** as an extreme statement for emphasis. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use a different way to express the emphasis. Alternate translation: [Nearly everyone lies in wait for bloodshed]

See: Hyperbole

Micah 7:2 (#2)

אָבַ֤ד חָסִיד֙

“The faithful one has perished”

Micah is not referring to a specific **faithful one**. He means faithful people in general. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [All the faithful people have perished]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Micah 7:2 (#3)

וְיָשָׁ֥ר בָּאָדָ֖ם אָ֑יִן

“and there is no upright one among mankind”

Micah is not referring to a specific **upright one**. He means upright people in general. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and there are no upright people among mankind]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Micah 7:2 (#4)

כֻּלָּם֙

“All of them”

The pronoun **them** refers to the people who live in the land. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [All of the people that are left in the land]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 7:2 (#5)

לְדָמִ֣ים יֶאֱרֹֽבוּ

“lie in wait for bloodshed”

Here, **bloodshed** represents violent death. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [are just waiting to murder each other]

See: Metonymy

Micah 7:2 (#6)

אִ֣ישׁ אֶת־אָחִ֔יהוּ יָצֹ֖דוּ חֵ֑רֶם

“each man hunts his brother with a net”

Here Micah is speaking the people of the land exploiting each other as if they were trappers that are trying to catch an animal **with a net**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [each man seeks to trap his brother]

See: Metaphor

Micah 7:2 (#7)

אֶת־אָחִ֔יהוּ

“his brother”

Micah is speaking as if a man’s **brother**, or fellow Israelite, were his prey, whom he hunts to harm rather than someone he should love and protect. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [each man tries to harm his fellow Israelite]

See: Metaphor

Micah 7:3 (#1)

הָרַ֣ע

“evil”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **evil**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [doing evil things]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 7:3 (#2)

כַּפַּ֥יִם

“the two hands”

Here, **the two hands** represent the leaders who use them to do evil. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [these leaders]

See: Metonymy

Micah 7:3 (#3)

וְהַשֹּׁפֵט בַּשִּׁלֻּמִים

“and the judge, for the recompense”

Micah is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [and the judge is also asking for the recompense]

See: Ellipsis

Micah 7:3 (#4)

בַּשִּׁלֻּמִים

“for the recompense”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **recompense**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [to be paid]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 7:3 (#5)

וְהַגָּדוֹל דֹּבֵר הַוַּוַת נַפְשׁוֹ הוּא

“and the great one is speaking the desire of his very soul”

Micah is not referring to a specific **great one**. He means people in positions of power in general. If it would be helpful to your readers, you could use an expression that would be more natural in your language. Alternate translation: [and important people are speaking the desire of their very souls]

See: Generic Noun Phrases

Micah 7:3 (#6)

הַוַּוַת נַפְשׁוֹ הוּא

“the desire of his very soul”

Here, **his very soul** represents the great one himself. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [of what he himself strongly desires]

See: Metonymy

Micah 7:3 (#7)

הַוַּוַת נַפְשׁוֹ הוּא

“the desire of his very soul”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **desire**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [what he himself desires]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 7:3 (#8)

וַיְעַבְּתוּהָ

“and they weave it together”

The pronoun **they** refers to all of the powerful leaders. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and these leaders weave it together]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 7:3 (#9)

וַיְעַבְּתוּהָ

“and they weave it together”

Here Micah is speaking of the plot that these leaders are scheming together as if it were a net that they **weave** together. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and they plot it out together]

See: Metaphor

Micah 7:4 (#1)

כְּחֵדֶק

“is} like a brier”

The point of this comparison is that just as **a brier** wounds anyone who touches it, so is even the best person among these people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [injures anyone who comes near, just as a brier does]

See: Simile

Micah 7:4 (#2)

יָשָׁר מִמְּסוּכָכָה

“the upright, {worse} than a thorn hedge”

The point of this comparison is that just as **a thorn hedge** injures those who come near it, so is the one who seems to be one of **the upright** people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [the upright person injures people even more than a thorn hedge injures those who come near it]

See: Simile

Micah 7:4 (#3)

יָשָׁר

“the upright”

Micah is using the adjective **the upright** as a noun to mean a certain kind of person. Your language may use adjectives in the same way. If not, you can translate this adjective with an equivalent phrase. Alternate translation: [the most honest person]

See: Nominal Adjectives

Micah 7:4 (#4)

יוֹם מְצַפָּיִךְ

“The day of your watchers”

Micah is using the term **day** to refer to a specific time and **your watchers** represents the prophets, who warned the people. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [The time that your prophets warned you about]

See: Metonymy

Micah 7:4 (#5)

מְצַפָּיִךְ פְּקֻדָּתְךְ

“your watchers, your visitation”

The pronoun **your** refers to the people of Israel, whom Micah addresses directly here. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [your watchers, people of Israel, your visitation]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 7:4 (#6)

פְּקֻדָּתְךְ

“your visitation”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **visitation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [when God comes to punish you]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 7:4 (#7)

עַתָּה תִּהְיֶה מְבוּכָתָם

“Now their confusion will be”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **confusion**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [When that happens, they will be confused and panic]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 7:5 (#1)

שְׁמֹר פִּתְחֵי־פִיךָ

“guard the doors of your mouth”

Micah is using **guard the doors of your mouth** as a common expression of the culture to mean “be very careful about what you say.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [you should guard what you say]

See: Idiom

Micah 7:6 (#1)

כַּלָּה בַּחֲמֹתָהּ

“a daughter-in-law against her mother-in-law”

Micah is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [a daughter-in-law is rising up against her mother-in-law]

See: Ellipsis

Micah 7:6 (#2)

אֹיְבֵי אִישׁ

“The enemies of a man”

Micah is using the possessive form to describe **enemies** who are characterized by their relationship to **a man**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [The ones who oppose a man]

See: Possession

Micah 7:6 (#3)

אַנְשֵׁי בֵיתוֹ

“are} the men of his house”

Micah is using the possessive form to describe **the men** who are characterized by living in **his house**. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way as modeled in the UST.

See: Possession

Micah 7:7 (#1)

וַאֲנִי֙ בַּיהוָ֔ה אֲצַפֶּ֑ה

“But I, I will watch for Yahweh”

Micah is stating the pronoun **I** separately, even though the verb translated as **I will watch** already includes this meaning. He is doing that to emphasize the contrast between himself and the people he has been describing. If a speaker of your language would use an explicit pronoun for the same purpose, you may want to use that construction in your translation. If not, your language may have other ways of showing the meaning here. Alternate translation: [But unlike these people, I will watch for Yahweh]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 7:7 (#2)

לֵאלֹהֵ֥י יִשְׁעִ֖י

“the God of my salvation”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **salvation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the God who saves me]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 7:7 (#3)

אֱלֹהָ֖י

“My God”

Moses is not using this possessive form **My God** to indicate that he possesses or controls Yahweh. Rather Moses is using these words to indicate that Yahweh is the God whom he worships. Alternate translation: [Yahweh, the God whom I worship,]

See: Possession

Micah 7:8 (#1)

אַל־תִּשְׂמְחִ֤י אֹיַבְתִּי֙ לִ֔י כִּֽי־נָפַ֖לְתִּי קָ֑מְתִּי כִּֽי־אֵשֵׁ֤ב בַּחֹשֶׁךְ֙ יְהוָ֔ה אֹ֖ור לִֽי

“Do not rejoice over me, my enemy! Though I have fallen; I will arise. Though I sit in the darkness; Yahweh {is} a light to me”

In verses 8 through 10 Micah speaks on behalf of his people. If it would be helpful, you could translate the singular pronouns as plurals, as in the UST.

See: Synecdoche

Micah 7:8 (#2)

אֹיַבְתִּי֙

“my enemy”

By **my enemy**, Micah refers to the nation that Micah foresees will conquer Israel. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [you enemy nation of my people]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 7:8 (#3)

נָפַ֖לְתִּי קָ֑מְתִּי

“I have fallen; I will arise”

Here Micah is speaking on behalf of the people about suffering defeat as if it were to have **fallen** down and of recovering as if it were to **arise** again. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [we have suffered disaster; we will be restored]

See: Metaphor

Micah 7:8 (#4)

אֵשֵׁ֤ב בַּחֹשֶׁךְ֙ יְהוָ֔ה אֹ֖ור לִֽי

“I sit in the darkness; Yahweh {is} a light to me”

Here Micah is speaking of the trouble his people are experiencing as if it were **the darkness** and of Yahweh’s help as if it were **a light**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [we are in trouble; Yahweh helps us]

See: Metaphor

Micah 7:9 (#1)

זַ֣עַף יְהוָ֣ה אֶשָּׂ֔א כִּֽי־חָטָ֥אתִי לֹ֖ו

“I will bear the rage of Yahweh, for I have sinned against him”

If it would be more natural in your language, you could reverse the order of these phrases, since the second phrase gives the reason for the result that the first phrase describes. Alternate translation: [Because I have sinned against Yahweh, I will bear his rage]

See: Connect — Reason-and-Result Relationship

Micah 7:9 (#2)

זַ֣עַף יְהוָ֣ה

“the rage of Yahweh”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **rage**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [how Yahweh rages against me]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 7:9 (#3)

יָרִ֥יב רִיבִ֖י

“he pleads my case”

Micah is using a construction in which a verb and its object come from the same root. You may be able to use the same construction in your language to express the meaning here. Alternatively, your language may have another way of saying this. Alternate translation: [pleads my plea]

See: Poetry

Micah 7:9 (#4)

מִשְׁפָּטִֽי

“my justice”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **justice**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [what is just for me]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 7:9 (#5)

יוֹצִיאֵ֥נִי לָאוֹר

“He will bring me out to the light”

Here Micah is speaking as if Yahweh’s rescue of him were bringing him out into **the light**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [He will rescue me]

See: Metaphor

Micah 7:9 (#6)

אֶרְאֶ֖ה בְּצִדְקָתֽוֹ

“I will look on his righteousness”

Here Micah is speaking as if experiencing what Yahweh does were to **look on** it. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I will experience his righteous acts]

See: Metaphor

Micah 7:9 (#7)

בְּצִדְקָתֽוֹ

“on his righteousness”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **righteousness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [on how righteous he is]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 7:10 (#1)

וְתֵרֶ֣א אֹיַבְתִּי֮ וּתְכַסֶּ֣הָ בוּשָׁ֒ה

“Then may my enemy see, so that shame covers her”

The pronoun **my** refers to Micah, who speaks here on behalf of his people, and **my enemy** and **her** refer to the nation that Micah foresees will conquer Israel. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [Then may the enemy nation of my people see, so that shame covers them]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 7:10 (#2)

וְתֵרֶ֣א אֹיַבְתִּי֮

“Then may my enemy see”

Micah is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context of the end of the last verse if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [Then may my enemy also see what Yahweh has done]

See: Ellipsis

Micah 7:10 (#3)

וְתֵרֶ֣א אֹיַבְתִּי֮

“Then may my enemy see”

Micah is saying what he wants his enemy to do. See the discussion in the introduction to this book about “let” and “may” and follow the decision of your team of how a speaker will express in this context what he wants someone to do. Alternate translation: [I desire that my enemy see] or [Please allow my enemy to see]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Micah 7:10 (#4)

וּתְכַסֶּהָ בוּשָׁה

“so that shame covers her”

Here Micah is speaking as if **shame** were a garment that **covers** a person. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [so that she becomes utterly ashamed]

See: Metaphor

Micah 7:10 (#5)

וּתְכַסֶּהָ בוּשָׁה

“so that shame covers her”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **shame**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [so that she feels ashamed]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 7:10 (#6)

אַיֵּ֣ה יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהָ֑יִךְ

“Where {is} Yahweh your God”

The enemy is using the question form to mock Micah by suggesting that Yahweh is unwilling or unable to help him. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [Yahweh your God is nowhere to be found!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Micah 7:10 (#7)

יְהוָ֣ה אֱלֹהָ֑יִךְ

“Yahweh your God”

The enemy is not using this possessive form **your God** to indicate that Micah possesses or controls Yahweh but rather to emphasize that Yahweh is the God that he worships. Alternate translation: [Yahweh, the God whom you worship]

See: Possession

Micah 7:10 (#8)

עֵינַ֥י תִּרְאֶ֖ינָה בָּ֑הּ

“My eyes will look at her”

Micah is using one part of a person, his **eyes**, to mean all of him in the act of watching his enemy’s downfall. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [I will watch what happens to her]

See: Synecdoche

Micah 7:10 (#9)

כְּטִ֥יט חוּצ֖וֹת

“like the mud of the streets”

The point of this comparison is that just as **the mud of the streets** is trampled underfoot and despised, so will Micah’s enemy be. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [as thoroughly despised as the mud that people tread on in the streets]

See: Simile

Micah 7:11 (#1)

יוֹם֙ לִבְנ֣וֹת גְּדֵרָ֔יִךְ

“A day to build your walls”

Micah is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [A day will come to build your walls]

See: Ellipsis

Micah 7:11 (#2)

גְּדֵרָ֔יִךְ

“your walls”

The pronoun **your** refers to the people of Zion. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [your walls, people of Zion]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 7:12 (#1)

וְעָדֶ֖יךָ יָבֹֽוא

“when as far as you he will come”

The pronoun **you** refers to Zion, or Jerusalem, and the pronoun **he** refers to each person who will come to the city of Jerusalem from the distant places named in this verse. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [when many people will come to Jerusalem]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 7:13 (#1)

וְהָיְתָה הָאָ֖רֶץ לְשַׁמָּמָ֑ה

“And the land will become a desolation”

Micah uses the word **And** here to indicate a contrast between the restoration that he has just described and the desolation that will come upon the rest of the earth. In your translation, indicate this contrast in a way that is natural in your language. Alternate translation: [But all the rest of the land will become a desolation]

See: Connect — Contrast Relationship

Micah 7:13 (#2)

לְשַׁמָּמָ֑ה

“a desolation”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **desolation**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [desolate]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 7:13 (#3)

יֹשְׁבֶ֖יהָ מִפְּרִ֥י מַעַלְלֵיהֶֽם

“her inhabitants, from the fruit of their deeds”

The pronoun **her** refers to the land, and the pronoun **their** refers to the people who live in the land. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [the land’s inhabitants, from the fruit of those people’s deeds]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 7:13 (#4)

מִפְּרִ֥י מַעַלְלֵיהֶֽם

“from the fruit of their deeds”

Here Micah is speaking of the results of what people do as if they were **the fruit** that a plant produces. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [from the results of their deeds]

See: Metaphor

Micah 7:14 (#1)

רְעֵ֤ה עַמְּךָ֙ בְּשִׁבְטֶ֔ךָ צֹ֖אן נַחֲלָתֶ֑ךָ

“Shepherd your people with your rod, the flock of your inheritance”

Here Micah is speaking as if Yahweh were a shepherd and as if Yahweh’s people were **the flock** that he tends. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [Care for your people as a shepherd cares for his flock, the people who belong to you]

See: Metaphor

Micah 7:14 (#2)

רְעֵ֤ה עַמְּךָ֙

“Shepherd your people”

The word translated as **Shepherd** is an imperative, but it communicates a polite request to a superior rather than a command. If the imperative does not communicate a request for your readers, then use a form in your language that communicates a polite request to a superior. Alternate translation: [Yahweh, please shepherd your people]

See: Imperatives — Other Uses

Micah 7:14 (#3)

צֹ֖אן נַחֲלָתֶֽךָ

“the flock of your inheritance”

Micah is using the possessive form to describe **the flock** that is characterized by being **your inheritance**, that is, the people whom Yahweh has chosen to belong to him. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the flock that belongs to you]

See: Possession

Micah 7:14 (#4)

יִרְעוּ

“May they graze”

Micah is saying what he wants Yahweh to do. See the discussion in the introduction to this book about “let” and “may” and follow the decision of your team of how a speaker will express in this context what he wants someone to do. Alternate translation: [I desire that they graze] or [Please allow them to graze]

See: Third-Person Imperatives

Micah 7:15 (#1)

כִּימֵ֥י צֵאתְךָ֖ מֵאֶ֣רֶץ מִצְרָ֑יִם

“As in the days of your going out from the land of Egypt”

The point of this comparison is that just as Yahweh did wonderful things in **the days of your going out from the land of Egypt**, so he will do wonderful things for his people again. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [Just as I did wonderful things when you came out from the land of Egypt]

See: Simile

Micah 7:15 (#2)

אַרְאֶנּוּ

“I will make him see”

The pronoun **I** refers to Yahweh, who begins to speak here, and the pronoun **him** refers to the people of Israel. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [I, Yahweh, will make my people Israel see]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 7:15 (#3)

נִפְלָאוֹת

“wonders”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **wonders**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [marvelous things that I do]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 7:16 (#1)

יִרְאוּ גוֹיִם

“The nations will see”

Micah is leaving out some of the words that in many languages a sentence would need in order to be complete. You can supply these words from the context of the previous verse if that would be clearer in your language. Alternate translation: [The nations will see what Yahweh has done]

See: Ellipsis

Micah 7:16 (#2)

גְּבוּרָתָם

“their might”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **might**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the mighty things they thought they had done]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 7:16 (#3)

יָשִׂימוּ יָד עַל־פֶּה

“They will put a hand over mouth”

Micah is using **put a hand over mouth** as a common expression of the culture to mean “be too astonished to speak.” If this phrase does not have that meaning for your readers, you could use a comparable expression from your language that does have that meaning, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [They will be too astonished to speak]

See: Idiom

Micah 7:16 (#4)

אָזְנֵיהֶם תֶּחֱרָשְׁנָה

“their ears will be deaf”

Here, **their ears** represents their ability to hear. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [they will lose their ability to hear]

See: Metonymy

Micah 7:17 (#1)

יְלַחֲכוּ עָפָר כַּנָּחָשׁ

“They will lick dust like the serpent”

The point of this comparison is that just as **the serpent** crawls low along the ground in the dust, so will the nations be brought low before Yahweh. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [They will be brought low, licking the dust like the serpent that crawls along the ground]

See: Simile

Micah 7:17 (#2)

יְלַחֲכוּ

“They will lick”

The pronoun **They**, here and throughout this verse, refers to the nations mentioned in the previous verse. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [The nations will lick]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 7:17 (#3)

כְּזֹחֲלֵי אֶֽרֶץ

“like crawling things of the earth”

The point of this comparison is that just as **crawling things of the earth** creep along the ground, so will the nations come out of their strongholds in fear and humiliation. If it would be helpful in your language, you could make this point explicitly. Alternate translation: [like creatures that creep along the ground in fear]

See: Simile

Micah 7:17 (#4)

אֱלֹהֵֽינוּ

“our God”

Micah is using this possessive form **our God** to mean that Yahweh is the God whom he and his people worship, not that they possess or control him. If it would be helpful in your language, you could state this explicitly as modeled in the UST.

See: Possession

Micah 7:17 (#5)

מִמֶּֽךָּ

“because of you”

The pronoun **you** could refer to: (1) Yahweh, since his judgment makes sinners afraid, and the next verse addresses Yahweh directly, or (2) Israel, since Israel is addressed directly in verse 15, with no indication that that has changed. Alternate translation: [because of you, Israel]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 7:18 (#1)

מִי־אֵ֣ל כָּמ֗וֹךָ נֹשֵׂ֤א עָוֹן֙ וְעֹבֵ֣ר עַל־פֶּ֔שַׁע לִשְׁאֵרִ֖ית נַחֲלָתֽוֹ

“Who is a God like you, bearing iniquity and passing over transgression for the remnant of his inheritance”

Micah is using the question form to declare that no other god is like Yahweh. If a speaker of your language would not use the question form for that purpose, you could translate this as a statement or as an exclamation. Alternate translation: [No other God is like you, Yahweh, bearing iniquity and passing over transgression for the remnant of his inheritance!]

See: Rhetorical Question

Micah 7:18 (#2)

נֹשֵׂ֤א עָוֹן֙ וְעֹבֵ֣ר עַל־פֶּ֔שַׁע

“bearing iniquity and passing over transgression”

The expressions **bearing iniquity** and **passing over transgression** mean similar things. Micah is using the two terms together for emphasis. If it would be clearer for your readers, you could express the emphasis with a single phrase. Alternate translation: [fully forgiving all the sinful actions]

See: Doublet

Micah 7:18 (#3)

עָוֹן֙

“iniquity”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **iniquity**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the bad things people do]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 7:18 (#4)

פֶּ֔שַׁע

“transgression”

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **transgression**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [what people have done wrong]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 7:18 (#5)

לִשְׁאֵרִ֖ית נַחֲלָתֽוֹ

“for the remnant of his inheritance”

Micah is using the possessive form to describe **the remnant** that is characterized by being **his inheritance**, that is, the people who belong to Yahweh who have remained faithful to him. If a speaker of your language would not use the possessive form for this, you could express this idea in another way. Alternate translation: [for those people who belong to him because they are still faithful to him]

See: Possession

Micah 7:18 (#6)

נַחֲלָתֽוֹ

“his inheritance”

Even though Micah is addressing Yahweh directly, he is speaking of him in the third person using **his** and "he". If it would be helpful in your language, you could translate these pronouns throughout this section in the second person for consistency as modeled in the UST.

See: First, Second or Third Person

Micah 7:18 (#7)

לֹא־הֶחֱזִיק לָעַד אַפּוֹ

"He does not hold his nose forever"

Here, **his nose** represents Yahweh's anger. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [He does not hold on to his anger forever]

See: Metonymy

Micah 7:18 (#8)

חֶסֶד

"covenant faithfulness"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **covenant faithfulness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [being faithful to his covenant]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 7:19 (#1)

יִכְבֹּשׁ עֲוֹנֹתֵינוּ

"He will subdue our iniquities"

Here Micah is speaking as if the sins of his people were enemies that Yahweh will **subdue**. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [He will overcome the power of our iniquities]

See: Metaphor

Micah 7:19 (#2)

עֲוֹנֹתֵינוּ וְתַשְׁלִיךְ בִּמְצֻלוֹת יָם כָּל־חַטֹּאותָם

"our iniquities, and you will throw into the depths of the sea all of their sins"

The pronouns **our** and **their** both refer to Micah and his people. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [all of our people's iniquities, and you will throw into the depths of the sea all of our sins]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 7:19 (#3)

עֲוֹנֹתֵינוּ

"our iniquities"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **iniquities**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [the wicked things we have done]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 7:19 (#4)

וְתַשְׁלִיךְ בִּמְצֻלוֹת יָם כָּל־חַטֹּאותָם

"and you will throw into the depths of the sea all of their sins"

Here Micah is speaking as if the sins of his people were objects that Yahweh could **throw into the depths of the sea**, where no one could ever recover them. Your language may have a comparable expression that you can use in your translation, or you could state the meaning plainly. Alternate translation: [and you will completely remove all of their sins forever]

See: Metaphor

Micah 7:19 (#5)

וְתַשְׁלִיךְ

"and you will throw"

The pronoun **you** refers to Yahweh, whom Micah addresses directly here after speaking about him in the previous sentence. It may be helpful to clarify this for your readers. Alternate translation: [and you, Yahweh, will throw]

See: Pronouns — When to Use Them

Micah 7:20 (#1)

אֱמֶת

"trustworthiness"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **trustworthiness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [proof that you are trustworthy]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 7:20 (#2)

לְיַעֲקֹב חֶסֶד לְאַבְרָהָם

"to Jacob, covenant faithfulness to Abraham"

Here, **Jacob** and **Abraham** represent the descendants of these two men. If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language. Alternate translation: [to Jacob's descendants, covenant faithfulness to those who descended from Abraham]

See: Metonymy

Micah 7:20 (#3)

חֶ֖סֶד לְאַבְרָהָ֑ם

"covenant faithfulness to Abraham"

If your language does not use an abstract noun for the idea of **covenant faithfulness**, you could express the same idea in another way. Alternate translation: [you will faithfully keep the covenant promise you made to Abraham]

See: Abstract Nouns

Micah 7:20 (#4)

לַאֲבֹתֵ֥ינוּ

"to our fathers"

Here, **fathers** represents "ancestors." If it would be helpful in your language, you could use an equivalent expression or plain language as modeled in the UST.

See: Metonymy